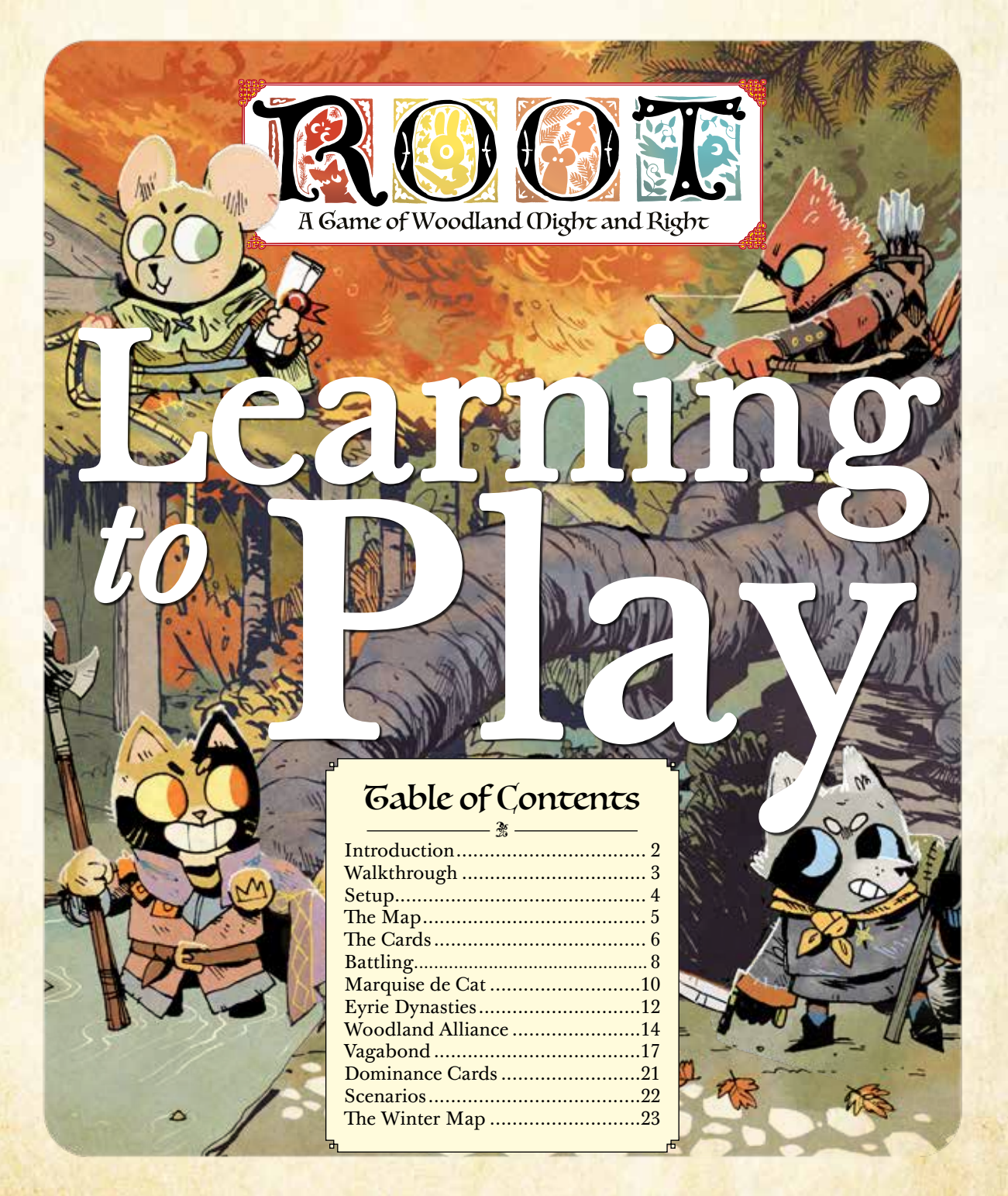




ROOFT

A Game of Woodland Might and Right

Learning to Play

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Introduction

Root is a fast-paced game of adventure and war. You will play as one of four factions vying to show that you are the most legitimate ruler of the vast Woodland.

Flow of Play

Each turn is split into three phases: **BIRDSONG**, **DAYLIGHT**, and **EVENING**. Once you play through these phases in order, your turn ends, and the player to your left begins their turn. The three phases are described in detail on each player's faction board.

Victory and Gaining Victory Points

You can win in one of two ways: **score 30 victory points** or **play and complete a dominance card**. Dominance cards cannot be played early in the game, so we recommend learning about them later—they are described more on page 21.

In Root, you will play one of four factions. Each scores victory points in its own way.



The invading **Marquise de Cat** wishes to exploit the Woodland, using its vast resources to fuel her economic and military machine. She scores by **constructing buildings** in the Woodland.



The proud **Eyrie Dynasties** wish to reclaim the glory of their once-great aristocracy and retake the Woodland from the Marquise. They score each turn by **building and protecting roosts** in the Woodland.



The upstart **Woodland Alliance** wish to unite the creatures of the forest and rise up against their oppressors. They score by **spreading sympathy** for their cause across the Woodland.



The wily **Vagabond** wishes to gain fame—or infamy—in the midst of this brewing conflict. He scores by **completing quests** for the creatures of the Woodland and by **aiding and harming the other factions**.

As you read on, you'll learn more about the factions and how they score points, along with a couple ways that any faction can score points.



Walkthrough

If your group learns by playing and wants to jump into Root without needing a long rules explanation, you can use the Walking through Root booklet.

Skip this page if your group prefers to learn most of the rules before starting play.

Ideally, one person should read through this Learning to Play guide before your group meets to play. We'll assume this person is you.

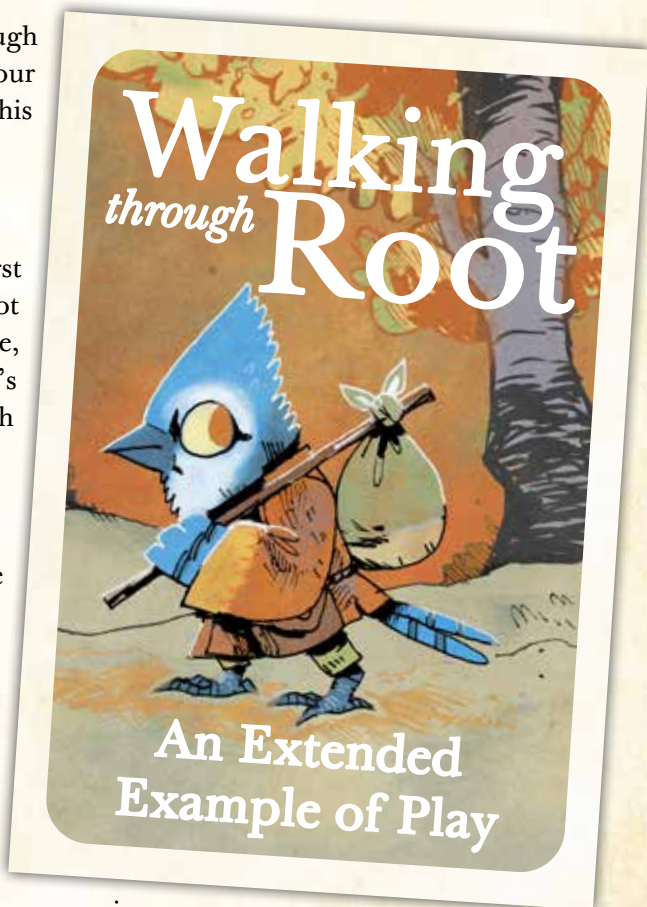
Setup

Follow the modified setup rules on the first two pages of the Walking Through Root booklet. Once you have set up the game, give the players an overview of Root's theme and the victory conditions for each faction. Now you're ready to play.

Play

Give the booklet to the Marquise player and ask them to read the text aloud as they take the actions described. When their turn is over, pass the booklet to the Eyrie player so they can do the same. Continue this until you reach the end. The booklet also answers some common questions and gives strategy tips—feel free to read these bits aloud and discuss them as much as your group enjoys.

Throughout this process, encourage everyone to ask questions. You will likely be able to answer questions about shared concepts such as moving and battling without much reference to the Learning to Play guide. If someone asks about their faction, encourage them to look over their faction board—it is designed to answer most of those questions. Don't be dismayed if play needs to stop so you can discuss some finer points. For most players, Root is best learned organically. After a few rounds, the game should flow seamlessly.



Setup

If playing with three players, remove the Vagabond. If playing with two, also remove the Alliance. For more faction mixes, see page 22.

- 1st **Choose Factions.** Each player chooses a faction board and takes all of their faction's pieces.

The back of each faction board lists all of its **pieces** and gives its **basics of play**.



- 2nd **Set Scores.** Place the score marker for each faction in play on "0" on the score track.



- 3rd **Deal Cards.** Shuffle the shared deck of 54 cards, and deal three cards to each player.

Do not confuse this shared deck with the types of cards used by specific factions, as listed on the backs of their faction boards.



- 4th **Place Ruins.** Place the four ruin markers on the four slots on the map marked with "R."



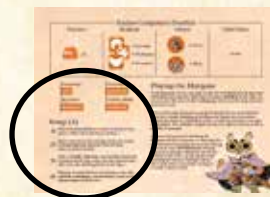
- 5th **Make Item Supply.** Gather the 12 item markers shown to the right and place them on their matching spaces near the top of the map.



- 6th **Gather Other Pieces.** Hand out the 16 faction overview cards as desired, and place the two custom dice near the map.



- 7th **Set Up Factions.** The players set up their factions, as described in Setup on the back of each faction board, in this order: Marquise, Eyrie, Alliance, Vagabond.



The Map

Most action in Root unfolds on the map of the Woodland, consisting of 12 **CLEARINGS** connected by **PATHS**.

A river runs through some clearings. Only use the river if the Riverfolk Company, an expansion faction, is in play.

Moving Around the Map

You can **MOVE** from clearing to clearing. When you move, take any number of your warriors from one clearing and move them to a clearing connected by a path.

The spaces on the Map enclosed by paths are **FORESTS**, which only the Vagabond can move into.

To move, you must **RULE** the clearing you are moving from **or** moving to.

You rule a clearing if you have the most combined **warriors and buildings** there. On a tie, no one is ruler.

Various other actions in Root will require you to rule clearings.



Warriors



Buildings

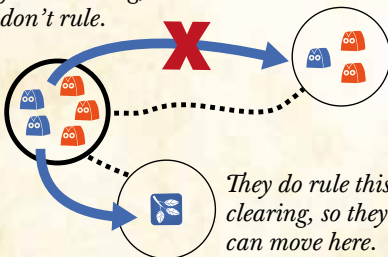


Tokens

Move Example



The Eyrie want to move out of this clearing, which they don't rule.



They don't rule this clearing either, so they cannot move here.

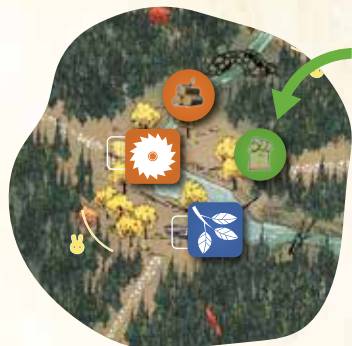
They do rule this clearing, so they can move here.

Clearings

Each clearing on the map has one to three **SLOTS**, which hold **BUILDINGS** that players will place. A clearing with no open slots cannot hold more buildings.



Slots filled with ruins cannot hold buildings until the Vagabond explores them. Without a Vagabond, these slots will be blocked for the entire game.



Each clearing also has a **SUIT**: fox, rabbit, or mouse. A clearing's suit represents the community living there.

Though both slots in this clearing are full, tokens can still be placed here.

A clearing's suit is shown both by its symbol and by the color of the clearing's trees.

The Cards

Throughout play, you will draw cards from Root's shared deck into your hand, and many actions will require you to spend cards from your hand. *Spending a card represents calling upon animals to lend you their labor, to do you a favor, or to broker a deal.*

Just like clearings, each card has a **SUIT**. Besides the fox, rabbit, and mouse suits, cards have a fourth suit: **BIRD**.



Birds Are Wild: The birds live in the treetops across the whole Woodland, so you can always treat a bird card as a mouse, fox, or rabbit card. However, if you must spend a bird card, you can't substitute a card of another suit.

Matching Example

Let's say you want to act in a fox clearing.



*If the action said you must spend a **matching** card, you could spend a fox or a bird card, since birds are wild.*



OR



Crafting Cards

Most cards have a second use—you can **CRAFT** the card to gain its effect, shown at the bottom.

To craft a card, you must activate **CRAFTING PIECES** in the clearings shown in the card's bottom-left corner.

You can activate each crafting piece only once per turn. Each faction has a different crafting piece, as follows.

Crafting Pieces			
	Marquise crafts with workshops.		Alliance crafts with sympathy.
	Eyrie crafts with roosts.		Vagabond crafts with hammers.



Immediate Effect

If the card gives you an **IMMEDIATE EFFECT** (PAPER BOX), resolve it and then discard the card.

A common immediate effect is to take an **ITEM** from the map's supply and place it in the Crafted Items box in the top-right corner of your faction board.

vp Whenever you craft an item, you score the victory points listed on the card!

If the supply does not have the matching item to take, you **cannot** craft the card.



Persistent Effect

If the card gives a **PERSISTENT EFFECT** (STONE BOX), place it face up near you. You may use its effect as written.

You cannot craft a persistent effect if you already have one of the same name.

Crafting Example



The Marquise wants to craft a Gently Used Knapsack, which costs one mouse.



The Marquise crafts by activating workshops.



Across the map, the Marquise has two fox workshops and two mouse workshops.



So, the Marquise can activate one of these mouse workshops to craft this card!



She takes the matching item from the supply, scores one victory point, and discards the card.

Battling

You can **BATTLE** other players to remove their pieces from the map.

When you battle, choose any clearing where you have any warriors. You are the attacker, and you choose another faction with any pieces there as the defender.

BROADLY, A BATTLE HAS TWO STEPS:

- » **First, roll two dice.** The attacker deals hits equal to the **higher** roll, and the defender deals hits equal to the **lower** roll. However, each player can roll no more hits than their number of warriors in the clearing of battle.
- » **Then, remove pieces.** Both players remove pieces at the same time. The player taking hits chooses which pieces to remove, but must remove all their own warriors in the clearing of battle before removing any of their own buildings or tokens there.

 Whenever you remove an enemy building or token—even outside battle—you score a victory point!

Extra Hits

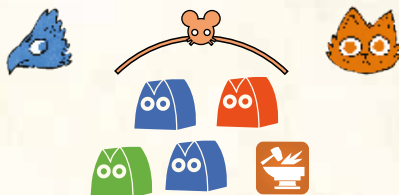
Some effects allow you to deal **EXTRA HITS**.

Extra hits represent superior positioning, tactics, or leadership. They are not limited by the number of warriors in the clearing of battle, so a single warrior could deal multiple hits.

The attacker deals an extra hit if the defender has no warriors in the clearing of battle, leaving themselves **DEFENSELESS**.

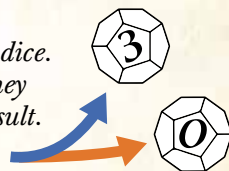
Battle Example

The Eyrie attack the Marquise.



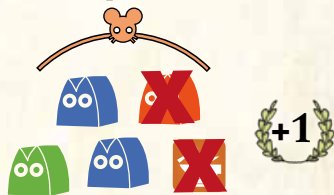
First...

The Eyrie roll the dice. As the attacker, they take the higher result.



Then...

Both sides deal hits. The Eyrie only have two warriors, so they only deal two hits. The Marquise deals zero hits.



The Marquise returns her warrior to her supply and her building to her board. The Eyrie score a victory point for removing a building, and the Marquise loses no victory points.

Ambush Cards

Before the roll in battle, the defender may play an **AMBUSH CARD** whose suit matches the clearing of battle to deal two hits **immediately**.

Since ambushes deal hits immediately, they can reduce the maximum number of hits the attacker can roll.

However, if the defender plays an ambush card, the attacker can foil the ambush, canceling its effect, by also playing a matching ambush card.

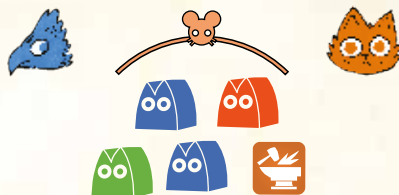
Like extra hits, ambush hits are not limited by your number of warriors in the clearing of battle.

You can even play an ambush card if you're **DEFENSELESS**! If you've got an ambush card in hand, don't be afraid to bait your enemies into attacking you where you seem weak.

If an ambush card removes all of the attacker's warriors, the battle immediately ends.

Ambush Example

The Eyrie attack the Marquise.

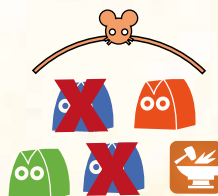


But...

*The Marquise plays a bird ambush card!
Birds are wild, so this card matches the mouse clearing.*



The Eyrie cannot foil the ambush, so they must remove two warriors, returning them to their supply. The battle ends.



Marquise de Cat



*The Marquise de Cat occupies the Woodland and wants to turn it into an industrial and military powerhouse. Each time the Marquise builds one of her **buildings**—a workshop, sawmill, or recruiter—she scores victory points. The more of the same building she has on the map, the more points she scores. However, to fuel ongoing construction, the Marquise must maintain and protect a strong, interconnected economy of **wood**.*

The **Keep of Marquise de Cat** grants two special abilities while it is on the map. First, no one but the Marquise can place pieces in the clearing with the keep token. Also, whenever Marquise warriors would be removed, the Marquise may call on her **Field Hospitals**, spending a card matching the warriors' clearing to place them back in the clearing with the keep token.

Birdsong

Place one wood token at each sawmill.

Daylight

First, you can craft any cards in your hand using workshops. Then, you can take up to three of the following actions.

- » **Battle:** Initiate a battle.
- » **March:** Take up to two moves.
- » **Recruit:** Place one warrior at each recruiter. You may take this action only once per turn.
- » **Build:** Place one building in a clearing you rule with an open slot by spending wood tokens equal to its cost. You may spend any wood on the map connected to this clearing by any number of clearings you rule. When you place the building, score the victory points revealed on your faction board.
- » **Overwork:** Spend a card to place one wood token at one sawmill in a clearing whose suit matches the card spent.

Hawks for Hire: You may take any number of extra actions by spending one bird card per extra action.

Unless otherwise noted, any faction may take actions listed in the same phase in any order, and may take a given action multiple times.

Daylight Example

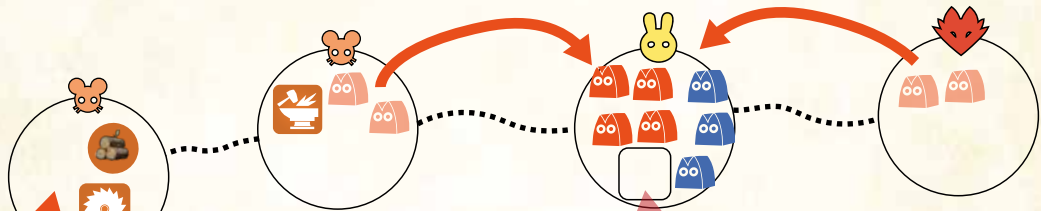
First, the Marquise decides to craft the Gently Used Knapsack, so she activates one mouse workshop. She scores a victory point and puts the item in her Crafted Items box.



Then, she begins to take her actions:

She starts by taking the March action, which lets her move twice.

She moves two warriors from a mouse clearing, which she rules, to a rabbit clearing, which she doesn't.



For her second move, she moves another two warriors into the clearing. She now rules the rabbit clearing.

For her second and third actions, she takes the Overwork action twice, spending a mouse and a bird card to put two extra wood in a mouse clearing with a sawmill.

Though she has taken three actions, she would like to go again, so she spends a bird card to get an extra action (Hawks for Hire). With this action she decides to build. Because she rules the rabbit clearing, she can now build in its empty slot. The next sawmill to be built costs three wood, so she spends wood from the nearby mouse clearing. Then, she scores three victory points.



Evening

Draw one card plus one card per uncovered draw bonus. Then, if you have more than five cards in your hand, discard down to five.

Most of the other factions draw and discard during Evening in exactly the same way.

Eyrie Dynasties



*The Eyrie Dynasties wish to restore their once-dignified kind to their former glory in the Woodland by resettling the forest clearings. During their Evening, the Eyrie score victory points from their number of **roosts** on the map. The greater their presence, the greater their gains. However, the Eyrie are bound by their **Decree**, an ever-increasing set of mandated actions promised by their **leader**. Each turn, they must take all of the actions on their Decree, or else fall into **turmoil**.*

The Eyrie are the **Lords of the Forest**. They rule a clearing even when tied for presence. However, their **Disdain for Trade** means they score less when crafting items.

Birdsong

You **must** add one or two cards onto any columns in the Decree. Only one card added may be a bird card.

Emergency Orders: If you have no cards at the start of Birdsong, draw one.

A New Roost: If you have no roosts, place one roost and three warriors in the clearing with the fewest warriors.

Daylight

First, you may craft any number of cards, using roosts.

Then, you **must** resolve the Decree, starting with the leftmost column and moving right. In each column, you may resolve cards in any order.

For each card in a column, you must take the action listed by the column in a clearing matching the card. Here are the actions in the four columns of the Decree:

- » **Recruit:** Place a warrior in a matching clearing with a roost.
- » **Move:** Move at least one warrior from a matching clearing.
- » **Battle:** Initiate a battle in a matching clearing.
- » **Build:** Place a roost in a matching clearing you rule with an open slot and no roost.

Evening

First, score the victory points shown on the rightmost empty space of your Roosts track.



Then, draw one card plus one per uncovered draw bonus. If you have more than five cards in your hand, discard down to five.

Turmoil

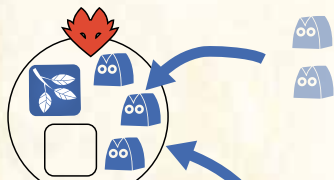
If you cannot take an action for any reason, you fall into **TURMOIL**. Follow these steps:

- » **First, your regime is humiliated.** Lose one victory point per bird card in the Decree.
- » **Then, your court is purged.** Discard all of the cards in the Decree except the two Loyal Vizier bird cards.
- » **Next, your leader is deposed.** Flip your current leader face down and set it aside, choose a new leader from those face up, and place it on your faction board. Then, tuck your Loyal Viziers into the Decree spaces listed on your new leader.
- » **Finally, you rest.** End Daylight and go to Evening.

There are many ways to fall into turmoil! For example, you might not have any warriors in your supply to recruit, or maybe all the clearings you rule already have a roost, meaning you can't build any more.

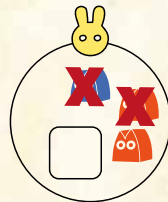
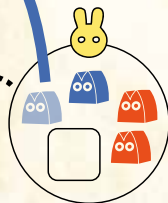
Decree Example

The Eyrie's Decree has a bird and fox card in the Recruit column, and a rabbit card in the Move column, a bird card on the Battle column, and a bird card on the Build column.



For the recruit, Eyrie choose to treat the bird card as a fox card and so place two warriors in a fox clearing with a roost.

Next, the Eyrie must move at least one warrior from a rabbit clearing.



Then, the Eyrie must battle. They only have a target in the rabbit clearing.

In the battle the Eyrie and Marquise each lose one warrior.

Finally, the Eyrie must place a roost in a clearing they rule that does not have a roost already. They have nowhere to place a roost, so the dynasty enters turmoil!

Woodland Alliance



The Woodland Alliance works to gain the **sympathy** of the various oppressed creatures of the Woodland. Each time the Alliance places a sympathy token, they score victory points. The more sympathy on the map, the more victory points they score. Gaining the sympathy of the people requires **supporters**, cards on the Alliance's faction board. These supporters can also be put toward violent **revolt**. A revolt establishes a new **base**, allowing the Alliance to train **officers** that increase their military flexibility.

The Alliance are experts in **Guerrilla War**. When defending in battle, the Alliance uses the higher roll and the attacker uses the lower roll.

Supporters, Sympathy, and Outrage

To act as the Alliance, you often spend **SUPPORTERS**—cards in your Supporters stack. Supporters are separate from your hand of cards, and you can only spend supporters for their suit. For example, you couldn't craft a card in the Supporters stack or play an ambush card there to deal hits.

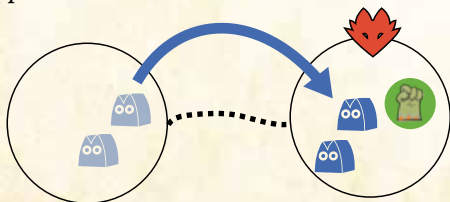
Supporter Limits: If you don't have a base on the map, you may only have up to five supporters. Discard any excess cards.

Supporters are often spent to place sympathy tokens. Placing sympathy is the main way you score victory points, and sympathy can gain you more supporters through **Outrage**.

Whenever another player removes a sympathy token or moves any warriors into a clearing with a sympathy token, they must add a card from their hand matching that clearing to your Supporters stack. If they don't have a matching card, they show you their hand, and then you draw a card from the deck and add it to your Supporters stack.

Outrage Example

The Eyrie would like to move into the fox clearing. Because it has a sympathy token, they must pay one fox card to the Alliance's Supporters stack.



Supporters Stack



Then the Eyrie battle in the fox clearing and remove the sympathy token. They must now pay another fox card to the Supporters stack. The Eyrie pay a bird card. If they couldn't pay, the Alliance would have drawn a card from the deck to add to their Supporters stack.

Birdsong

You may revolt any number of times, and then spread sympathy any number of times.

- » **Revolt:** Spend two supporters matching a sympathetic clearing. Remove all enemy pieces there and place the matching base. Then, place warriors there equal to the number of sympathetic clearings matching the suit of the revolt clearing, including the revolt clearing itself. Last, place a warrior in the Officers box.

Whenever you remove a base, you'll have to remove half your officers and discard all supporters matching the suit of that base—even your bird supporters!

- » **Spread Sympathy:** Place a sympathy token in an unsympathetic clearing, adjacent to a sympathetic clearing if possible. You must spend supporters as shown by the cost on your Sympathy track. If the target clearing has three or more warriors of another player, you must spend another matching supporter to place sympathy there.



If there are no sympathy tokens on the board, you can place your first sympathy in any clearing.

Birdsong Example

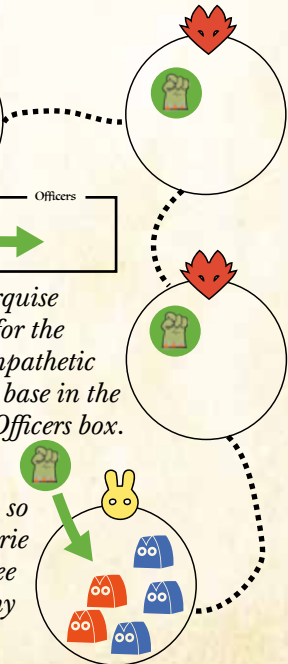
At the start of Birdsong, the Alliance sees a sympathetic fox clearing as a prime target for revolt, so they take the opportunity, spending a fox and a bird from their Supporters stack.

Supporters Stack



This revolt removes the Eyrie's roost and two Marquise warriors, and the Alliance scores a victory point for the removed roost. Because the Alliance has three sympathetic fox clearings, they place three warriors and a fox base in the fox clearing of the revolt and one warrior in the Officers box.

Then, the Alliance places a sympathy token in a rabbit clearing. This is the fourth sympathy token, so it costs two rabbit supporters. Also, because the Eyrie have three warriors there, the cost increases to three rabbit supporters. The Alliance places the sympathy and scores one victory point.



Daylight

You may take the following actions. Unlike in Birdsong, these cards come from your hand, **not** your supporters.

- » **Craft:** Craft a card, using sympathy tokens.
- » **Mobilize:** Add a card to the Supporters stack.
- » **Train:** Spend a card whose suit matches a built base to place a warrior in the Officers box. This warrior is now an **OFFICER**.

Your **officers** determine the number of military operations you can take during Evening. Without officers, you can't move or battle with your warriors! Training officers will also let you recruit new warriors and place sympathy tokens without spending supporters.

Evening

You may take these military operations, up to your number of officers.

- » **Move:** Take one move.
- » **Battle:** Initiate a battle.
- » **Recruit:** Place a warrior in a clearing with a base.
- » **Organize:** Remove one of your warriors from an unsympathetic clearing to place a sympathy token there. Score the revealed victory points.



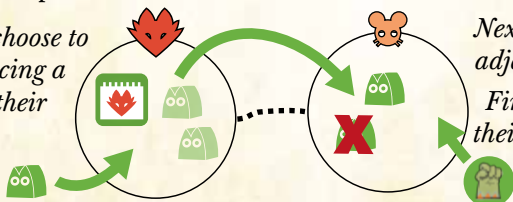
After you finish military operations, draw one card plus one per uncovered draw bonus. Then, if you have more than five cards in your hand, discard down to five.

Military Operations Example

It is now the start of Evening. The Alliance has three officers, so they can perform three operations.



First, they choose to recruit, placing a warrior at their fox base.



Next, they move two warriors to an adjacent mouse clearing.

Finally, they organize, removing one of their warriors to place a sympathy token in the mouse clearing.

Vagabond

*The Vagabond plays all sides of the conflict, making friends and enemies as suit his ends, while going on **quests** to increase his renown throughout the wood. As the Vagabond improves his **relationships** with other factions, or removes pieces of factions hostile toward him, he scores victory points.*

Being a **Lone Wanderer**, the Vagabond cannot rule a clearing or stop another player from ruling one, but he is **Nimble**, so he can move regardless of who rules his clearing.

The Vagabond only has one piece: the **VAGABOND PAWN**. This pawn can move and battle just like a warrior, but it is not a warrior and it can't be removed.

Items

To move and act effectively as the Vagabond, you must manage your **ITEMS**, expanding your selection by exploring the Woodland's **RUINS** and providing aid to other factions.

At any time, an item can be **DAMAGED** or **UNDAMAGED**, and an item can be either face up or down. You can **EXHAUST** an undamaged face-up item to perform an action.



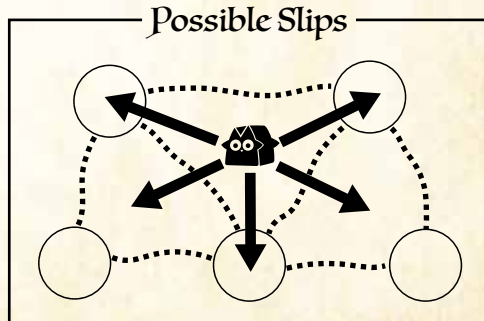
While undamaged, , , and  are stored on their tracks on the left side of your faction board, while all other items are stored in your Satchel. You can only carry so many items in your Satchel, and you will have to discard down to your item capacity during Evening.

Birdsong

Flip two items face up per  on its track at the start of Birdsong, then flip three more face up.

Then, you may slip once, moving into an adjacent clearing or forest without exhausting any .

Slip is the only way you can enter a forest!



Daylight

You can take various actions by exhausting items, flipping them face down.

- » **Move:** Exhaust a  to take a move.
- » **Battle:** Exhaust a  to initiate a battle.
- » **Strike:** Exhaust a  to remove a warrior in your clearing. If a player has no warriors there, you can instead remove a building or token of that player.
- » **Explore:** Exhaust a  to take one item from a ruin in your clearing and score one victory point. Remove the ruin from the map.
- » **Aid:** Exhaust any one item, and give a card from your hand matching your clearing to any player in your clearing. Then, take one item, if any, from their Crafted Items box.
- » **Quest:** Claim a quest whose suit matches your clearing by exhausting the two items listed on the quest. Place the claimed quest into your play area. Then, you may draw two cards from the deck, or you may score one victory point per quest of this suit that you have completed, including this one. Finally, draw and put out a new quest.
- » **Craft:** Exhaust  equal in number to the suits shown on a card's crafting cost. All of your  match the suit of your clearing.
- » **Repair:** Exhaust a  to repair a damaged item.
- » **Special Action:** Exhaust a  to take the action listed on your character card.

Evening

If you are in a forest, repair all of your damaged items.

Then, draw one card, plus one card per  on its track. If you have more than five cards in your hand, discard down to five.

Finally, if you have more items in your Satchel and Damaged box than your item limit—six plus two per  on its track—you must remove items from your Satchel down to your item limit. Return any removed items to the box.



*Vagabond's
Draw Bonus*

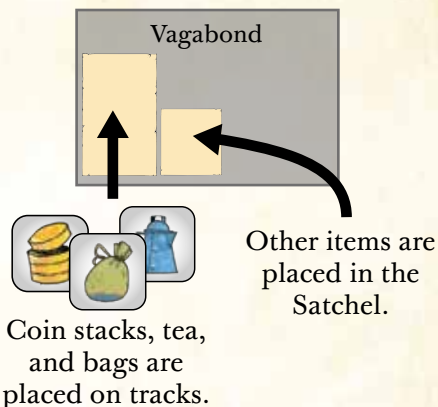
Unlike other factions, the Vagabond does not uncover draw bonuses, but instead gets draw bonuses as items. This item only adds a bonus draw if it is undamaged and face up on its matching track.

Shifting Items

You can freely move face-up, undamaged , , and  between your Satchel and their tracks. If you exhaust a , , or , you must move it to your Satchel.

When an item is damaged, move it to your Damaged box in your Satchel.

When an item is repaired, move it out of the Damaged box and back to the Satchel.



Relationships

Your Relationships chart represents how friendly or hostile other factions are toward you.

You can improve a relationship with a faction by giving them cards with the Aid action. During the same turn, you must take the Aid action the number of times shown between their current relationship space and the next one. When you improve a relationship, you score the victory points listed on the new space. When you reach the **Allied** space, you may move and battle with that faction's warriors. For more, see *Law of Root* (9.2.9).

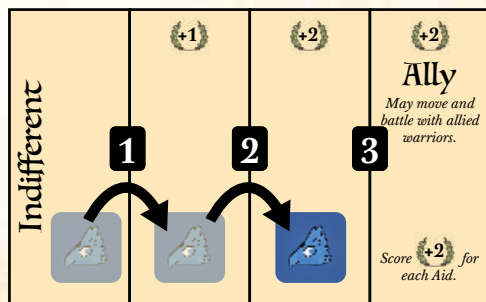
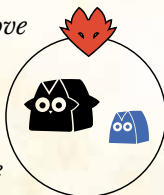
If you ever remove a warrior, place its faction's relationship marker in the **Hostile** box. From now on, you score a victory point each time you remove one of their pieces in battle during your turn, along with any points you score for removing buildings and tokens. However, you must exhaust another  whenever you move into a clearing with any Hostile warriors.

Aid and Improving Relationships Example

The Vagabond would like to improve his relationship with the Eyrie.

He shares a fox clearing with them, so he can target the Eyrie with the Aid action. Each time, he must exhaust an item and give a fox or bird card. He decides to aid three times.

The Vagabond advances the Eyrie marker two spaces and scores three victory points.



Battling as the Vagabond

Because you don't have warriors, you follow a few different rules in battle.

- » The Vagabond pawn is not a warrior, so you can't rule and you are not affected by effects that refer to warriors. You can battle where your pawn is.
- » The maximum hits you can deal by rolling equals your total undamaged , whether exhausted or not.
- » You take hits by damaging items of your choice. If you have no undamaged items, you ignore further hits.
- » You are defenseless, taking an extra hit, if you have no undamaged .

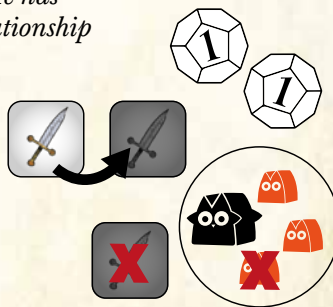


Vagabond Battle Example

The Vagabond is in a clearing with three Marquise warriors. He has two face-up swords in his Satchel. After a long and fruitful relationship with the Marquise, the Vagabond is ready to betray his friend.

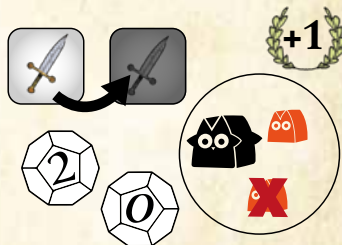
The First Battle

He exhausts a sword to battle the Marquise. The Marquise doesn't play an ambush card. The Vagabond then rolls the dice, rolling a 1 and a 1. The Vagabond deals one hit and moves the Marquise's relationship marker to Hostile. The Marquise also deals one hit, so the Vagabond chooses to damage the exhausted sword.



The Second Battle

Undeterred, he exhausts his second sword to battle again. The Marquise doesn't play an ambush card. The Vagabond then rolls the dice, rolling a 2 and a 0. With only one undamaged sword, the Vagabond can only deal one hit. Because he removed a warrior of a Hostile faction, the Vagabond scores one point.



Dominance Cards

The deck has four dominance cards, one in each suit. Like ambush cards, these cards cannot be crafted, but they can be spent for their suit.

When you discard or spend a dominance card for its suit, **do not discard it!** Instead, place it near the map. Any player, during their Daylight, may pick up a dominance card near the map by spending a card of matching suit.



Changing Your Victory Condition

During your Daylight, if you have at least 10 victory points, you may play a dominance card into your play area to **ACTIVATE** it. Remove your score marker from the score track. For the rest of the game, you can only win by meeting the victory condition listed on your activated dominance card.

Your activated dominance card does not count against your hand size, and it cannot be removed from play or replaced.

Forming a Coalition as the Vagabond

The Vagabond cannot rule clearings, but he can play a dominance card to form a **COALITION** with the player other than himself with the lowest score. If there's a tie for lowest score, the Vagabond chooses which player to form a coalition with.

When forming a coalition, the Vagabond removes his score marker from the score track and places it on the faction board of that player. Now, the Vagabond will share the victory if that player wins.

A Vagabond can even form a coalition with a Hostile faction! If doing so, the Vagabond moves his partner's relationship marker to the Indifferent space.



Faction Combinations

Root can be played with many combinations of factions. The following list is not exhaustive. Other combinations are possible but may be more fragile and thus require experienced, aggressive players. We offer some recommended mixes (marked with a torch) as ideal ways to introduce the game to new players.

When playing with two players, do not use the dominance cards. The two player game is also best played over the course of two full games (each takes about 30-45 minutes). After the first game, players should record their scores and trade factions. After the second game, each player should add their scores from both games to determine the winner.

Two Players



Eyrie versus Marquise is an ideal two-player learning game. The Eyrie must grow explosively to keep the Marquise in check.



Two-player Alliance games offer Alliance players a chance to hone their skills in difficult situations. They will usually fare better against the Eyrie, but well-timed revolts and rapid mobilization can vex the Marquise as well.



Here the Eyrie must be careful to build a Decree that can withstand the Vagabond's nimble attacks.

Three Players



The struggle between the Marquise and the Eyrie will be the defining characteristic of these games. Vagabond and Alliance alike must be careful to pick their friends and not create a situation that they cannot later control.



Here, the Vagabond will have a natural friend in the Alliance. Both should watch out for dominance victory and not neglect developing their military strength.



Four Players



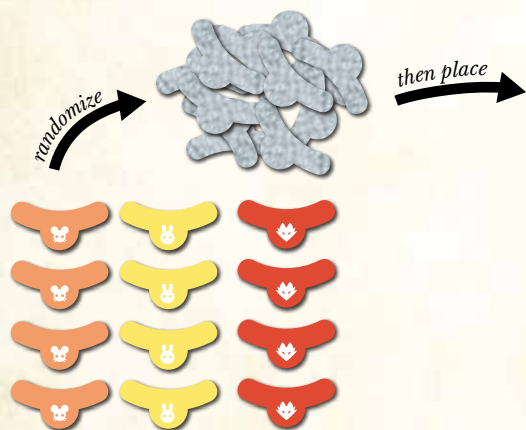
With the map brimming with interlopers, the Marquise must not neglect policing the Woodland in the hopes of scoring a few extra victory points. If she loses control, she will not easily regain it.

The Winter Map

The reverse side of the autumn map is the winter map. You can play any mix of factions on this map, but it is recommended only for experienced players.

Setup

Before playing on the winter map, take out the 12 suit markers, flip them face down, and shuffle them. Then, place one suit marker near each clearing on the map. After a suit marker has been added to each clearing, flip them all over, and set up the game as normal. Note the different placement of ruins, as shown below.



The Raging River

On the winter map, the river divides forests as if it were a path.

A Warning

On the winter map, the randomness of clearing suits can introduce many new challenges to each faction. Keep the map's geography in mind when picking factions, and understand that certain factions may gain new advantages and disadvantages in each possible layout.

A Note from Leder Games:
Sometimes errors happen during manufacturing. If you feel a part of your game is missing or arrived damaged please contact us at our website (www.ledergames.com) or email us at support@ledergames.com and we will be happy to work with you to replace the missing piece.

Piece Glossary



Warriors, which can move around the map and battle pieces of other players. They add to rule.



Tokens, which can be placed in clearings but do not fill slots. They do **not** add to rule.



Buildings, which start on faction boards and can be placed in empty slots in clearings. They add to rule.



Markers, which track things like victory points and the Vagabond's relationships with other factions.



Ruins, which fill slots in clearings. The Vagabond can explore ruins to find items and empty their slots.



Items, which the Vagabond exhausts to take actions. All factions can craft items.



The Vagabond Pawn, which can move around the map and battle pieces of other players. It is **not** a warrior and does **not** add to rule.

Crafting Pieces



Marquise crafts with workshops.



Alliance crafts with sympathy.



Eyrie crafts with roosts.



Vagabond crafts with hammers.

HAVE MORE QUESTIONS?
READ *THE LAW OF ROOT*!



THE LAW OF ROOT



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Reading the Law

Text in SMALL CAPITALS defines key terms. Text in italics gives reminders and clarifications. Faction icons mark rules modified by Faction Rules and Abilities sections.

Root contains two rulebooks: the Learning to Play guide and this book, the Law. If you like a conversational teaching style and many graphical examples, read the Learning to Play guide. If you like a strictly defined, formal rules in a concise reference style, read the Law.

These rules of thumb will help you interpret the Law.

Q1. I'd like to do something, and the rules don't say that I can't do it. Can I do it?

A1. Within the confines of the action, yes! The game will often surprise you with outlandish, unexpected situations, and that's part of the fun, but this doesn't mean you can flip the table.

Q2. Can another player not consent to an action?

A2. No actions require consent. Just do the thing.

Q3. It seems like something should happen, but the rule doesn't tell me to do that thing. What do I do?

A3. Follow the literal word of the Law, not your instinct, even if a similar rule exists.

Q4. A rule uses a specific term or action. Does it also include another, closely related term or action?

A4. Nope! Assume we mean only the original term and not any related terms. For example, the terms MOVE and PLACE are different, which is important in rules such as The Keep (6.2.2).

If you have any other questions, check our website for more answers: ledergames.com/root

If you have any missing or damaged components, you can go here for support: ledergames.com/replacements

1. Golden Rules

This chapter gives answers to technical, detailed questions. You do not need to read it when first learning.

1.1 RULES CONFLICTS

- 1.1.1 **Precedence.** If a card conflicts with the Law, follow the card. If the Learning to Play guide conflicts with the Law, follow the Law. If you can follow both a general rule and a faction or hiring rule, follow both; if you cannot, follow the faction or hiring rule.
- 1.1.2 **Use of CANNOT.** The term CANNOT is absolute. It cannot be overridden unless explicitly instructed.
- 1.1.3 **Unclear Resolutions and Choices.** Whenever it is unclear what order simultaneous effects should resolve in, or which player should make a decision, the player taking their turn chooses.

1.2 PUBLIC AND PRIVATE INFORMATION

- 1.2.1 **Hands.** Players may only show or reveal cards in their hand if explicitly instructed, but the number of cards in their hand is public information. 
- 1.2.2 **Discard.** The discard pile can be searched and inspected at any time.

1.3 NEGOTIATION AND DEALS

- 1.3.1 **Agreements.** Players may discuss the game and make agreements, but they are non-binding.
- 1.3.2 **Cards.** Players may only give cards to each other if explicitly instructed.

1.4 GAME STRUCTURE

- 1.4.1 **Turn Structure.** Each player's turn has three phases: Birdsong, Daylight, and Evening. Anything that says "at start of" a phase happens before everything else in the phase, and anything that says "at end of" happens after everything else in the phase but before the start of the next phase, if any. After a player ends Evening, the next clockwise player begins their turn. Play continues until one player has won the game (3.1).
- 1.4.2 **Interrupts.** You cannot interrupt an action (including a compound action such as the Marquise's March), ability (such as the Corvids' Exposure), or persistent effect (such as the Eyrie Emigre card) with another effect unless it explicitly allows it. (For example, the Armorers card says it is used "In battle...").

1.5 PIECES

- 1.5.1 **Limits.** Pieces are limited by the contents of the game. Do not use proxy pieces if you run out.
- 1.5.2 **Starting Faction.** Each player owns the faction they choose in setup (5) and the pieces listed on the back of its faction board except for items. Generically, these are called FACTION PIECES or similar. Specifically, these are called [FACTION NAME] PIECES. (For example, "your faction warriors" and "warriors of your faction" and "Marquise warriors" all refer to the orange wooden cat-shaped warriors.)
- 1.5.3 **Piece Ownership.** The ownership of faction pieces cannot change. (For example, the Marquise cannot use Field Hospitals on Riverfolk mercenaries or hirelings, since these are not Marquise warriors.)
- 1.5.4 **Piece Manipulation.** Pieces are placed and removed as defined in the Glossary (G.1.19, G.1.22). If you are prompted to place, take, or remove pieces but you cannot do so fully, you must place, take, or remove the maximum number possible. (This does not let you avoid costs or prerequisites. You just cannot do less than the most you can.) If multiple pieces are removed simultaneously and that would trigger effects, remove all pieces before triggering effects.
- 1.5.5 **Use of FORCE.** Some effects let you FORCE a player or their pieces to act. Resolve this exactly as if that player were choosing to do this, as limited by the effect. (For example, if you force the Eyrie to move warriors, they benefit from Lords of the Forest.)

2. Key Concepts

Terms are defined strictly in the Glossary (Appendix G).

2.1 CARDS

You draw cards from the top of the shared deck, and discard to a shared discard pile. If the deck is ever empty, shuffle the discard pile immediately to form a new deck. Each card has a SUIT: bird, fox, rabbit, or mouse. Most cards also have an effect you can craft (4.1). 🐿

2.1.1 **Birds Are Wild.** You can treat any bird card as a card of another suit, even if you must spend, take, or give multiple cards of the same suit. 🐿

I **Forced Effects.** If you are prompted to discard or give cards of non-bird suits, you must treat your bird cards as a prompted suit.

II **Reverse Substitution.** If you are prompted to spend, discard, take, or give a bird card, you cannot substitute a card of another suit.

2.1.2 **Ambush Cards.** There are five AMBUSH CARDS: one mouse, one rabbit, one fox, and two birds. You may spend an ambush card for its suit, but it does not have a crafted effect. You may also play one in battle to deal hits (4.3.1).

2.1.3 **Dominance Cards.** There are four DOMINANCE CARDS matching the four suits. You may spend a dominance card for its suit, but it cannot be crafted. You may also play one to permanently change your victory condition (3.3).

2.2 CLEARINGS AND PATHS

The map of the Woodland is composed of many CLEARINGS linked by PATHS.

2.2.1 **Adjacency.** A clearing is adjacent to all other clearings linked to it by a path. 🐿

2.2.2 **Suit.** Each clearing has a SUIT: mouse, rabbit, or fox.

2.2.3 **Slots.** Each clearing has a number of BUILDING SLOTS (*white boxes*). Whenever you place a building, it fills an open slot. You cannot place a building in a clearing with no open slots.

2.2.4 **Ruins.** Slots marked with a small “R” begin the game filled with RUINS. Ruins cannot be removed unless explicitly instructed (*such as by the Vagabond’s Explore action, 9.5.3*).

2.3 RIVERS

Many clearings are linked by RIVERS. (*Rivers are not paths, but can be treated as paths if explicitly instructed. Rivers do not divide clearings or forests.*) 🌊

2.4 FORESTS

Areas on the map enclosed by printed paths and clearings are called FORESTS.

2.4.1 **Adjacency.** A forest is adjacent to all clearings that touch it without crossing a printed path, and it is adjacent to all forests that are separated by only one printed path.

2.5 RULE

A player RULES a clearing if they have more total warriors and buildings in it than each other player. (*Tokens and pawns do not contribute to rule.*) If there is a tie between players in a clearing, no one rules it. 🐿🐿🐿

3. Victory

3.1 HOW TO WIN

The first player to reach 30 victory points immediately wins the game. If multiple players reach 30 or more victory points simultaneously, the player taking the current turn wins.

3.2 SCORING VICTORY POINTS

Each faction has a unique way to score victory points, but any faction can score victory points as follows.

3.2.1 **Removing Buildings and Tokens.** Whenever you remove an enemy’s building or token, you score one victory point.

3.2.2 **Crafting Items.** Whenever you craft an item (4.1), score the victory points listed on the card. 🐿🐿

3.3 DOMINANCE CARDS

The deck has four dominance cards, which let you win the game without scoring 30 victory points.

3.3.1 **Activating.** During your Daylight, if you have at least 10 victory points, you may ACTIVATE a dominance card in your hand by placing it in your play area. Remove your score marker from the score track. You can no longer score victory points. 🐿

I **Mouse, Rabbit, or Fox Dominance.** You win the game immediately if you rule three clearings of the suit matching the activated dominance card at the start of your Birdsong.

II **Bird Dominance.** You win the game immediately if you rule two clearings in opposite corners at the start of your Birdsong.

3.3.2 **Activated Cards.** An activated dominance card does not count against your hand limit, and it cannot be removed from play. You cannot replace an activated dominance card with a different one.

3.3.3 **Using Dominance Cards.** A dominance card can be spent for its suit. Anytime a dominance card would be placed in the discard pile, instead place it near the map to show it is AVAILABLE to be taken. 🐿

3.3.4 **Taking Available Cards.** During your Daylight, you can take an available dominance card into your hand by spending a card of matching suit. You cannot treat an available bird dominance card as a non-bird suit.

4. Key Actions

4.1 CRAFT

You can CRAFT most cards from your hand to gain an immediate or persistent effect.

- 4.1.1 **Cost.** To craft a card, you must ACTIVATE crafting pieces of the suits listed in the card's bottom-left corner. (*A faction's crafting piece is listed in its Crafting section.*) A crafting piece's suit matches its clearing. Each crafting piece may be activated only once per turn. A three-color question mark denotes a crafting piece of any suit. ♠♣♥
- 4.1.2 **Immediate Effects.** When you craft an immediate effect (*paper box*), resolve its effect and then discard the card. If it shows an item, take the matching item from the item supply on the map and place it in the Crafted Items box on your faction board. If the card lists an item not in the item supply, the card cannot be crafted. ♠♣♥
- 4.1.3 **Persistent Effects.** When you craft a persistent effect (*stone box*), place it in your play area. You may use the effect described on the card.
- 4.1.4 **No Duplicates.** You cannot craft a persistent effect if you have an identical one in your play area.

4.2 MOVE

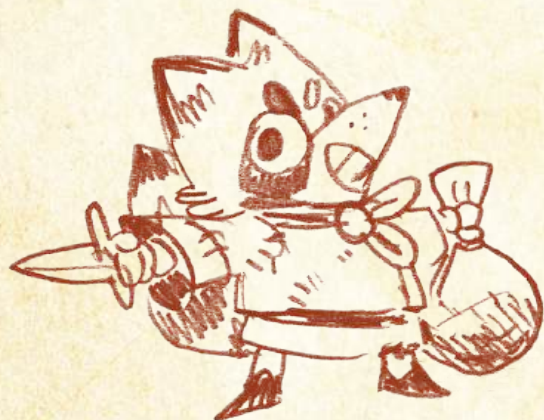
When you MOVE, take any number (*more than zero*) of your warriors and pawns from one clearing and move them on a linking path (2.2) to one adjacent clearing.

- 4.2.1 **You Must Rule.** To take a move, you must rule the origin clearing, destination clearing, or both. ♠♣♥
- 4.2.2 **No Movement Limits.** A given piece can be moved any number of times per turn. If you are prompted to take multiple moves, you may move the same or separate groups of warriors.

4.3 BATTLE

When you BATTLE, choose a clearing with any number of your warriors and pawns as the CLEARING OF BATTLE. You are the ATTACKER. Choose an enemy in the clearing of battle to be the DEFENDER.

- 4.3.1 **Step 1: Defender May Ambush.** The defender may play one ambush card matching the clearing of battle. If so, resolve 4.3.1.I–II in order.



- I **Foil Ambush.** The attacker may also play an ambush card matching the clearing of the battle. If they do, the defender discards their ambush card and skips 4.3.1.II.

- II **Resolve Ambush.** The defender deals two hits immediately (4.3.4). Then, the defender discards the ambush card. If no attacking warriors or pawns remain, end the battle immediately.

- 4.3.2 **Step 2: Roll Dice.** Roll both dice. The attacker will deal hits equal to the higher roll, and the defender will deal hits equal to the lower roll. If the rolls are equal, attacker and defender will deal the same number of hits. (*The use of "will" here reflects that hits are not dealt until step 4.*) ♠

- I **Maximum Rolled Hits.** The maximum hits you can deal from rolling equals the number of your warriors in the clearing of battle, whether you are the attacker or defender. ♠

- 4.3.3 **Step 3: Use Effects.** The attacker and defender may use optional effects (*such as the Brutal Tactics card*) that affect battle. If both want to use effects, the attacker chooses who uses them first (1.1.3).

- I **Extra Hits.** Many effects will deal EXTRA HITS, which are not limited by the number of warriors in the clearing of battle.

- II **Defenseless.** If the defender has no warriors in the clearing of battle, the attacker will deal an extra hit. ♠

- 4.3.4 **Step 4: Deal Hits.** Each hit that a side deals removes one piece of the other side from the clearing of battle. (*You score one victory point per enemy building or token removed.*) The side taking hits chooses the order in which their own pieces are removed, but all of their warriors there must be removed before any of their buildings or tokens there can be removed; they also choose the order of any effects triggered by their pieces being removed.

5. Setup

If any players are new to the game, use the Standard Setup (5.1) If everyone has played and you want more variety, use the Advanced Setup (Appendix A). If you want to play with five or more factions that would start in corner clearings, you must use the Advanced Setup.

5.1 STANDARD SETUP

- 5.1.1 **Step 1: Assign Factions and Starting Player.** Assign one faction to each player in any way. Determine the starting player and seating order randomly. Each player takes their chosen faction board and the pieces listed on its back.
- 5.1.2 **Step 2: Place Score Markers.** Each player places their score marker on "0" on the score track.
- 5.1.3 **Step 3: Draw Starting Hands.** If you are playing with two players, remove all four dominance cards from the deck. Shuffle the deck. Each player draws three cards.
- 5.1.4 **Step 4: Place Ruins.** Place a ruin in each slot on the map marked with an "R" (*four in total*).

- 5.1.5 **Step 5: Form Item Supply.** Place these items on the matching spaces of the item supply near the top of the map: 2 , 2 , 1 , 1 , 2 , 2 .
- 5.1.6 **Step 6: Gather Other Pieces.** Hand out the 16 faction overview cards as desired, and place the two dice near the map.
- 5.1.7 **Step 7: Set Up Factions.** In setup order (A, B, C, etc.), each player follows their faction's setup instructions, listed in their rules section and on the back of their faction board.

5.2 REACH

To set up an interesting game, choose factions whose REACH values add up to at least the total reach recommended for your player count. (*Adventurous players are welcome to use any faction mix with 17+ Reach.*)

Viable Reach Sums					
Players	2	3	4	5	6
Total Reach	17+	18+	21+	25+	28+

Reach Values	
Marquise de Cat	10
Lord of the Hundreds	9
Keepers in Iron	8
Underground Duchy	8
Eyrie Dynasties	7
Vagabond (first/second)	5/2
Riverfolk Company	5
Woodland Alliance	3
Corvid Conspiracy	3
Lizard Cult	2

6. Marquise de Cat

6.1 OVERVIEW

The Marquise de Cat occupies the Woodland and wants to turn it into an industrial and military powerhouse. Each time the Marquise builds one of her BUILDINGS—a workshop, sawmill, or recruiter—she scores victory points. The more of the same building she has on the map, the more points she scores. However, to fuel ongoing construction, the Marquise must maintain and protect a strong, interconnected economy of wood.

6.2 FACTION RULES AND ABILITIES

- 6.2.1 **Crafting.** The Marquise crafts during Daylight by activating workshops.
- 6.2.2 **The Keep.** The Marquise can place pieces in the clearing with the keep token, and other players cannot. (*Pieces may be moved into it. If the keep is removed, there is no way to place it on the map again.*)
- 6.2.3 **Field Hospitals.** Whenever any number of Marquise warriors are removed from a clearing, the Marquise may spend a card matching that clearing to place those warriors in the clearing with the keep token instead of the Marquise's supply.

6.3 FACTION SETUP

- 6.3.1 **Step 1: Gather Warriors and Wood.** Form supplies of 25 warriors and 8 wood tokens.
- 6.3.2 **Step 2: Place Keep.** Place the keep token in any corner clearing. This is your starting clearing.
- 6.3.3 **Step 3: Garrison.** Place a warrior in each clearing except the clearing in the diagonally opposite corner from the clearing with the keep token.
- 6.3.4 **Step 4: Place Starting Buildings.** Place 1 sawmill, 1 workshop, and 1 recruiter. You may place them among the clearing with the keep token and any adjacent clearings, in any combination.
- 6.3.5 **Step 5: Fill Buildings Tracks.** Place your remaining 5 sawmills, 5 workshops, and 5 recruiters on your matching Buildings tracks from right to left. (*Leave the leftmost space of each track empty.*)

6.4 BIRDSONG

Place wood tokens in each clearing with any number of sawmills, one wood per sawmill there.

6.5 DAYLIGHT

First, you may activate workshops to craft cards from your hand. Then, you may take up to three actions—plus one action per bird card you spend (*not as part of an action*)—in any order and number.

- 6.5.1 **Battle.** Initiate a battle.
- 6.5.2 **March.** Take up to two moves.
- 6.5.3 **Recruit.** Place one warrior at each recruiter. You may take this action only once per turn.
- 6.5.4 **Build.** Place a building.
- I **Choose Clearing and Building.** Choose a clearing you rule. Choose whether you want to place a sawmill, workshop, or recruiter. You will place the leftmost building of its type from your faction board. You must be able to pay its cost (6.5.4.II) and place it (6.5.4.III).
 - II **Pay Cost.** Find the chosen building's cost at the top of its column. Remove wood tokens equal in number to the cost from the chosen clearing, any adjacent clearings you rule, or any clearings connected to the chosen clearing you rule through any number of clearings you rule.
 - III **Place Building and Score.** Place the chosen building in the chosen clearing, and score the victory points listed on the space uncovered on your faction board.
- 6.5.5 **Overwork.** Spend a card matching the clearing of a sawmill, and place a wood token there.

6.6 EVENING

Draw one card, plus one card per uncovered draw bonus. Then, if you have more than five cards in your hand, discard cards of your choice until you have five.

7. Eyrie Dynasties

7.1 OVERVIEW

The Eyrie Dynasties wish to restore their once-dignified kind to their former glory in the Woodland by retaking control of the forest clearings. During their Evening, the Eyrie score victory points based on the number of ROOSTS on the map. The greater their presence in the Woodland, the greater their gains. However, the Eyrie are bound by their DECREE, an ever-increasing set of mandated actions promised by their LEADER. Each turn, they must take all of the actions on their Decree, or else fall into TURMOIL.

7.2 FACTION RULES AND ABILITIES

7.2.1 **Crafting.** The Eyrie craft before resolving the Decree during Daylight by activating roosts.

7.2.2 **Lords of the Forest.** The Eyrie rule a clearing when tied for most combined warriors and buildings there, and they have at least one Eyrie piece there. 

7.2.3 **Disdain for Trade.** Whenever the Eyrie craft an item, they ignore the listed victory points and instead score only one victory point. *(They can still score extra crafting points from effects such as Master Engravers and the Legendary Forge.)*

7.3 FACTION SETUP

7.3.1 **Step 1: Gather Warriors.** Form a supply of 20 warriors.

7.3.2 **Step 2: Place Roost and Starting Warriors.** Place 1 roost and 6 warriors in a corner clearing that is not the starting corner clearing of another player and, if possible, is diagonally opposite from a starting corner clearing. This is your starting clearing. *(This is updated from earlier printings for flexibility.)*

7.3.3 **Step 3: Choose Leader.** Choose 1 of the 4 Eyrie leader cards and place it in your Leader Card slot. Gather the remaining leaders face up near you.

7.3.4 **Step 4: Tuck Viziers.** Tuck your 2 Loyal Vizier cards, showing their suit, into the Decree columns above your faction board as listed on your leader.

7.3.5 **Step 5: Fill Roosts Track.** Place your 6 remaining roosts on your Roosts track from right to left.

7.4 BIRDSONG

Your Birdsong has three steps in the following order.

7.4.1 **Emergency Orders.** If you have no cards in your hand, draw one card.

7.4.2 **Add to the Decree.** You must add one or two cards to the Decree, but only one card added may be a bird card. You may play each card to any column, and each column can hold any number of cards.

7.4.3 **A New Roost.** If you have no roosts on the map, place a roost and three warriors in a clearing with the fewest warriors where all those pieces can be placed.

7.5 DAYLIGHT

Your Daylight has two steps in the following order.

7.5.1 **Craft.** You may activate roosts to craft cards from your hand.

7.5.2 **Resolve the Decree.** You must resolve the Decree, starting with the leftmost column and moving right. In each column, you must resolve all of its cards, but in any order. For each card, you must take the action listed for its column, as follows. If you cannot fully take an action, you immediately fall into turmoil (7.7).

I **Recruit.** Place a warrior in any clearing with a roost whose suit matches the card suit.

II **Move.** Move from any clearing whose suit matches the card suit. *(You must move at least one warrior.)*

III **Battle.** Initiate a battle in any clearing whose suit matches the card suit.

IV **Build.** Place a roost in any clearing you rule whose suit matches the card suit and which has no roost.

7.6 EVENING

Your Evening has two steps in the following order.

7.6.1 **Score Points.** Score the victory points listed on the rightmost empty space of your Roosts track.

7.6.2 **Draw and Discard.** Draw one card, plus one card per uncovered draw bonus. Then, if you have more than five cards in your hand, discard cards of your choice until you have five.

7.7 TURMOIL

If you cannot fully take an action in the Decree (7.5.2) for any reason, you fall into turmoil. You must take the Turmoil action as follows in order.

7.7.1 **Step 1: Humiliate.** Lose one victory point per bird card *(including Loyal Viziers)* on the Decree.

7.7.2 **Step 2: Purge.** Discard all of the cards on the Decree except your Loyal Viziers.

7.7.3 **Step 3: Depose.** Flip your current leader face down and set it aside, choose a new leader from those face up, and place on your faction board. Tuck your Loyal Viziers into the Decree spaces listed on your new leader.

I **A New Clutch.** If you must choose a new leader but none are face up, flip them all face up.

7.7.4 **Step 4: Rest.** End Daylight and begin Evening.

7.8 LEADERS REFERENCE

The Eyrie have four leader cards, as follows.

7.8.1 **Builder.** Loyal Viziers begin on Recruit and Move. Whenever you craft, you ignore your Disdain for Trade special ability (7.2.3).

7.8.2 **Charismatic.** Loyal Viziers begin on Recruit and Battle. Whenever you take a Recruit action, you must place two warriors instead of one.

- 7.8.3 **Commander.** Loyal Viziers begin on Move and Battle. In battle as attacker, you deal an extra hit.
- 7.8.4 **Despot.** Loyal Viziers begin on Move and Build. Whenever you remove at least one enemy building or token in battle, you score one extra victory point (*two in total, 3.2.1*).

8. Woodland Alliance

8.1 OVERVIEW

The Woodland Alliance works to gain the SYMPATHY of the various creatures of the Woodland who are dissatisfied with their present condition. Each time the Alliance places a sympathy token, they may score victory points. The more sympathy on the map they have, the more victory points they score. Gaining the sympathy of the people requires SUPPORTERS. These supporters can also be put toward violent ends, inciting outright rebellion across the forest. When a revolt erupts, the Alliance will establish a BASE. Bases allow the Alliance to train officers, increasing their military flexibility.

8.2 FACTION RULES AND ABILITIES

- 8.2.1 **Crafting.** The Alliance crafts during Daylight by activating sympathy tokens.
- 8.2.2 **Guerrilla War.** As defender in battle, the Alliance will deal hits equal to the higher roll, and the attacker will deal hits equal to the lower roll.
- 8.2.3 **The Supporters Stack.** To take various actions, the Alliance spends SUPPORTERS, which are cards on their Supporters stack. Supporters can only be spent for their suit and do not count against the Alliance's hand size. Supporters are face down, but the Alliance may inspect them at any time.
- I **Capacity.** If the Alliance has no bases on the map, the Supporters stack can only hold up to five cards. If the Alliance would gain a supporter but the stack cannot hold it, that card is discarded. If any bases are on the map, the Supporters stack can hold unlimited cards.
- 8.2.4 **Removing Bases.** Whenever a base is removed, the Alliance must discard all supporters matching the printed suit of the base (*including birds*) and remove half of their officers, rounded up. If the Alliance has no more bases on the map and has more than five supporters, they must discard down to five supporters.
- 8.2.5 **Sympathy Tokens.** The Alliance has 10 sympathy tokens.
- I **Placement Limits.** A clearing can hold only one sympathy token.
 - II **Terms.** A SYMPATHETIC CLEARING is one with a sympathy token. An UNSYMPATHETIC CLEARING is one without a sympathy token.
- 8.2.6 **Outrage.** Whenever another player removes a sympathy token or moves any warriors into a sympathetic clearing, they must add one card matching the affected clearing from their hand to the

Supporters stack. If they have no matching cards (*including no birds*), they must show their hand to the Alliance, and then the Alliance draws a card from the deck and adds it to the Supporters stack.

8.3 FACTION SETUP

- 8.3.1 **Step 1: Gather Warriors.** Form a supply of 10 warriors.
- 8.3.2 **Step 2: Place Bases.** Place 3 bases on the matching spaces in your Bases box.
- 8.3.3 **Step 3: Fill Sympathy Track.** Place 10 sympathy tokens on your Sympathy track.
- 8.3.4 **Step 4: Gain Supporters.** Draw 3 cards and place them face down on your Supporters stack.

8.4 BIRDSONG

Your Birdsong has two steps in the following order.

- 8.4.1 **Revolt.** Any number of times, you may take the Revolt action, as follows.
- I **Step 1: Choose Clearing.** Choose a sympathetic clearing that matches a base on your faction board.
 - II **Step 2: Spend Supporters.** Spend two supporters matching the suit of the chosen clearing.
 - III **Step 3: Resolve Effect.** Remove all enemy pieces from the chosen clearing. Then, place the matching base there, and place warriors there equal to the number of sympathetic clearings matching the base's printed suit. Finally, place one warrior in the Officers box. This warrior is now an OFFICER. (*Remember to score one victory point per token and building removed.*)
- 8.4.2 **Spread Sympathy.** Any number of times, you may take the Spread Sympathy action, as follows.
- I **Step 1: Choose Clearing.** Choose an unsympathetic clearing adjacent to a sympathetic clearing. If there are no sympathetic clearings, you may choose any clearing.
 - II **Step 2: Spend Supporters.** Spend supporters matching the suit of the chosen clearing. The number of supporters that must be spent is listed above the sympathy token.
 - a **Martial Law.** You must spend another matching supporter if the target clearing has at least 3 warriors of another player, including warriors they are treating as their own for rule (*Mercenaries, hirelings, etc.*).
 - III **Step 3: Place and Score.** Place a sympathy token in the chosen clearing. Score the victory points on the space uncovered on your faction board.

8.5 DAYLIGHT

You may take the following actions in any order and number.

- 8.5.1 **Craft.** You may activate sympathy tokens to craft a card from your hand.
- 8.5.2 **Mobilize.** Add a card from your hand to the Supporters stack.

- 8.5.3 **Train.** Spend a card whose suit matches the printed suit of a base on the map to place a warrior in the Officers box. This warrior is now an OFFICER.

8.6 EVENING

Your Evening has two steps in the following order.

- 8.6.1 **Military Operations.** You may take actions, as follows, up to your number of officers, in any order and number.
- I **Move.** Take one move.
 - II **Battle.** Initiate a battle.
 - III **Recruit.** Place a warrior in any clearing with a base.
 - IV **Organize.** Remove one Alliance warrior from an unsympathetic clearing, place a sympathy token there, and score the victory points listed on the space uncovered on your faction board.
- 8.6.2 **Draw and Discard.** Draw one card, plus one card per uncovered draw bonus. Then, if you have more than five cards in your hand, discard cards of your choice until you have five.

9. Vagabond ♠

9.1 OVERVIEW

The Vagabond plays all sides of the conflict while going on quests to increase his renown throughout the wood. Each time the Vagabond improves his RELATIONSHIP with another faction, or removes a warrior belonging to a faction hostile toward him, he scores victory points. He can also complete QUESTS to score victory points. To move and act effectively the Vagabond must manage his pack of ITEMS, expanding his selection by exploring the forest ruins and providing aid to other factions.

9.2 FACTION RULES AND ABILITIES

- 9.2.1 **Crafting.** The Vagabond exhausts ♠ to craft. All of his ♠ match the suit of his current clearing. If the Vagabond crafts an item, he may immediately take it, face up.
- 9.2.2 **Lone Wanderer.** The Vagabond pawn is not a warrior (*so he cannot rule a clearing or stop another player from ruling one*). The Vagabond pawn cannot be removed from the map.
- I **Full Removal.** Whenever an enemy player uses an effect that says it removes all enemy pieces from a clearing (*such as Alliance revolts, Favor of the Mice cards, Conspiracy bombs*) with the Vagabond, the Vagabond damages three items.
- 9.2.3 **Nimble.** The Vagabond can move regardless of who rules his origin or destination clearing (4.2.1).
- 9.2.4 **Defenseless.** In battle, the Vagabond is defenseless (4.3.2.II) if he has no undamaged ♠.
- 9.2.5 **Items.** The Vagabond's capabilities depend on the items he acquires. Instead of a Crafted Items box, he has a Satchel and various item tracks. Items on the Vagabond's faction board can be face up or

face down. The Vagabond EXHAUSTS face-up undamaged items, flipping them face down, to take many actions.

- I **Item Tracks.** When gained or flipped face up in the Satchel, ♠, ♣, and ♠ are placed face up on their matching tracks. When flipped face down, ♠, ♣, or ♠ on tracks are placed face down in the Satchel. Each track can only hold three matching items.
 - II **The Satchel.** When gained, ♠, ♣, ♠, ♠, and ♠ are placed face up in the Vagabond's Satchel.
- 9.2.6 **Maximum Rolled Hits.** In battle, the Vagabond's maximum rolled hits (4.3.2.I) equals his undamaged ♠, face up or face down, in his Satchel.
- 9.2.7 **Taking Hits.** Whenever the Vagabond takes a hit (4.3.3), he must damage one undamaged item, moving it to his Damaged box. If no undamaged items remain to damage, the Vagabond ignores any remaining hits.
- 9.2.8 **Dominance Cards and Coalitions.** The Vagabond cannot activate a dominance card for its normal victory condition (3.3.1). Instead, in games with four or more players, the Vagabond can activate a dominance card to form a coalition with another player, placing his score marker on that player's faction board. (*The Vagabond no longer scores points.*) That player must have fewer victory points than each other player except the Vagabond forming the coalition, and that player cannot be in a coalition. If there is a tie for fewest victory points, he chooses one tied player. If the coalitioned player wins the game, the Vagabond also wins.
- 9.2.9 **Relationships.** Your faction board shows a Relationships chart, which has four spaces on the Allied track and one Hostile box. It holds a relationship marker for each non-Vagabond faction.
- I **Improving Relationships.** You can improve a relationship with a non-Hostile faction by taking the Aid action.
 - a **Cost.** Aid a non-Hostile faction the number of times listed between their current Allied space and their next Allied space during the same turn. (*A given Aid action counts toward only one improvement in relationship.*)



- b **Effect.** Advance that faction's relationship marker one space right on the track. Score the victory points listed in the new space.
- II **Allied Status.** If a relationship marker reaches the final space on the Allied track, you are now ALLIED with the faction shown by that relationship marker. (*Their warriors trust you!*)
 - a **Aiding Ally.** Each time you Aid an Allied faction, score two victory points.
 - b **Moving with Ally.** Whenever you move to an adjacent clearing, you may also force warriors of one Allied faction to move from your origin clearing to your destination clearing along with your Vagabond pawn.
 - c **Attacking with Ally.** At the start of battle as the attacker, you may treat the warriors of one Allied faction in the clearing of battle as your own. The maximum hits you can roll equals the number of their warriors there plus your total undamaged . You cannot treat Allied warriors as your own when attacking the same Allied faction.
 - d **Taking Hits with Ally.** In a battle where you treat Allied warriors as your own, you can take hits by removing them. However, if you take more hits by removing Allied warriors than by damaging items during the same battle, that Allied faction becomes Hostile (9.2.9.III) at the end of the battle. This rule overrides the condition for becoming Hostile in 9.2.9.III.
- III **Hostile Status.** If you remove a warrior of a non-Hostile faction, move their relationship marker to the Hostile box. This faction is now HOSTILE. Then, if this happened in battle during your turn, check for Infamy scoring (9.2.9.IIIa).
 - a **Infamy.** Score one extra victory point for each piece of a Hostile faction you remove in battle during your turn, except the warrior that made the faction Hostile. (*Add this to points scored for enemy buildings and tokens.*)
 - b **Moving into Hostile Clearings.** You must exhaust an extra to move into a clearing with any warriors of any Hostile faction.
 - c **Aiding Hostile Factions.** You cannot move a relationship marker out of the Hostile box by using Aid, but you can still Aid a Hostile faction to take crafted items.
 - d **Coalition with Hostile Faction.** You can form a coalition (9.2.8) with a Hostile faction. If you do, move their relationship marker to the Indifferent space.

9.3 FACTION SETUP

- 9.3.1 **Step 1: Choose Character.** Choose a character card and place it in your Character Card slot.
- 9.3.2 **Step 2: Place Pawn.** Place your Vagabond pawn in any forest.

- 9.3.3 **Step 3: Get Quests.** Shuffle your quest deck, draw 3 quest cards, and place them face up near you.
- 9.3.4 **Step 4: Populate Ruins.** Take the 4 ruins from the map, and take the , , , and items marked with an "R." Place one beneath each ruin and then shuffle each ruin stack. Then, return each stack to an empty ruin slot on the map.
- 9.3.5 **Step 5: Take Starting Items.** Take the items marked with an "S" listed on your character card. Place any listed , , and items face up on the matching tracks of your faction board. Place all other listed items face up in your Satchel. Return any remaining "S" items to the box.
- 9.3.6 **Step 6: Set Relationships.** Take a relationship marker for each non-Vagabond faction and place them all on the Indifferent space of your Relationships chart.

9.4 BIRDSONG

Your Birdsong has two steps in the following order.

- 9.4.1 **Refresh.** Flip two exhausted items face up for each face up on the Refresh track at the start of your Birdsong. Then flip up three more exhausted items.
- 9.4.2 **Slip.** You may move into an adjacent clearing or forest without exhausting any , even for moving into a Hostile clearing (9.2.9.IIIb). This move ignores all effects that prevent movement out of a clearing (*such as the Corvids' snare*).

9.5 DAYLIGHT

You can exhaust items to take the following actions, in any order and number. If you exhaust a , , or on a track, move it to the Satchel.

- 9.5.1 **Move.** Exhaust one to move, plus one if the destination clearing has any Hostile warriors. You cannot move into a forest. If in a forest, you may only move into an adjacent clearing.
- 9.5.2 **Battle.** Exhaust one to initiate a battle. (*Check your relationship with the defender.*)
- 9.5.3 **Explore.** Exhaust one to take one item under a ruin in your clearing, reveal it, and place it face up in your Satchel or on its matching track. If you take an item, score one victory point. If you remove the last item from a ruin, remove the ruin.
- 9.5.4 **Aid.** Exhaust any one item, and give one of your cards matching your clearing to any player with faction pieces there (*even Hostile*). Then, you may take one item, if any, from that player's Crafted Items box, and place it face up in your Satchel or on its matching track. (*Check your relationship with that player's faction.*)
- 9.5.5 **Quest.** Choose a quest whose suit matches your clearing, and exhaust the two items listed on the quest to complete it. Place the quest in your play area, and then draw a new quest and place it near the map. You may score one victory point per quest of matching suit you have completed, including this one, OR draw two cards from the deck.

- 9.5.6 **Strike.** Exhaust one  to remove an enemy warrior from your clearing. If that enemy has no warriors there, you may instead remove one of their other faction pieces there. *(Check your relationship with that player's faction.)*
- 9.5.7 **Repair.** Exhaust one  to move one damaged item to the Satchel, keeping the item on its current side. *(Face-up , , and  immediately move to their tracks.)*
- 9.5.8 **Craft.** Play a card from your hand, and exhaust the  of listed suit to craft it. All of your  match the suit of your clearing. If a card requires multiple of one suit to craft, you must exhaust the listed number of . If you craft an item, you may place it face up in your Satchel or on the matching track.
- 9.5.9 **Special Action.** Exhaust one  to take the action listed on your character card.

9.6 EVENING

Your Evening has four steps, as follows.

- 9.6.1 **Rest.** If you are in a forest, move all items in your Damaged box to your Satchel or their matching track, and flip them face up.
- 9.6.2 **Draw Cards.** Draw one card, plus one card per  face up on the matching track.
- 9.6.3 **Discard Cards.** If you have more than five cards in your hand, discard cards of your choice until you have five.
- 9.6.4 **Check Item Capacity.** If you have more items total in your Satchel and Damaged box than your item limit—six plus two per  face up on the matching track—remove items from your Satchel and Damaged box until you have items equal to your item limit, and remove them from the game permanently.

9.7 PLAYING WITH TWO VAGABONDS

If you have *The Riverfolk Expansion*, you can play a game with two Vagabonds by following these rules.

- 9.7.1 **Setup.** Use both sets of “R” items and place two random “R” items in each ruin slot. If you are using the Standard Setup (5.1), randomly determine which Vagabond sets up first.
- 9.7.2 **Share Quests.** Either Vagabond may complete any of the three face-up quests. Do not add extra quest cards during setup.
- 9.7.3 **Taking Items from Ruins.** When a Vagabond explores a ruin with two items, or the Hundreds raze a ruin (14.4.1) with two items, that player may look at those items and take one of their choice. *(By taking two Explore actions, the Vagabond could take both items from one ruin.)* A player cannot take an “R” item if they have the same type of “R” item on their faction board. *(If the Vagabond explores but does not take an item, he does not score a victory point, but the  is still exhausted.)*

The next two sections refer to factions in The Riverfolk Expansion.

10. Lizard Cult

10.1 OVERVIEW

Catering to the discarded creatures of the Woodland, the Lizard Cult seeks to overwhelm its foes through sheer force of will. Wherever the Cult rules clearings, it can build GARDENS, using word of mouth and beak to spread its gospel to the animals living there. The firmer its hold over the hearts of its followers, the more victory points the Cult can score by completing the proper RITUALS. While other factions spend cards to achieve their aims, the Cult acts chiefly by revealing cards and gradually gathering a set of ideal followers. These revealed cards are returned to the Cult's hand in Evening, unless discarded to score victory points. However, this gentler approach makes movement and battle difficult—the Cult can only take these actions with its radicalized ACOLYTES, gained as the Cult's warriors are slaughtered while defending in battle.

10.2 FACTION RULES AND ABILITIES

- 10.2.1 **Crafting.** The Cult crafts during Evening by activating gardens whose printed suit matches the Outcast suit (10.4.1). *(Generally this matches the clearing, except with the Lost City landmark.)*
- 10.2.2 **Hatred of Birds.** Bird cards are not wild for Cult rituals.
- 10.2.3 **Revenge.** Whenever a Cult warrior is removed while defending in battle, it is placed in the Acolytes box instead of the Cult's supply.
- 10.2.4 **Pilgrims.** The Cult rules any clearings where they have any gardens. This overrides the Eyrie's Lords of the Forest (7.2.2).
- 10.2.5 **Fear of the Faithful.** Whenever a garden is removed, the Cult must discard a random card.
- 10.2.6 **The Lost Souls Pile.** Whenever any card is spent or discarded *(even a dominance card)*, place it in the Lost Souls pile instead of the discard pile. The Lost Souls pile can be inspected by any player at any time.

10.3 FACTION SETUP

- 10.3.1 **Step 1: Gather Warriors.** Form a supply of 25 warriors.
- 10.3.2 **Step 2: Place Warriors.** Place 4 warriors and 1 garden of matching printed suit in a corner clearing that is not the starting corner clearing of another player and, if possible, is diagonally opposite from a starting corner clearing. This is your starting clearing. Then place 1 warrior in each adjacent clearing. *(This is updated from earlier printings for flexibility.)*
- 10.3.3 **Step 3: Choose Outcast.** Place the outcast marker on any suit space in the Outcast box. The suit of this space is called the OUTCAST.

- 10.3.4 **Step 4: Fill Gardens Tracks.** Place your 14 remaining gardens on the matching spaces of your Gardens tracks from right to left.

10.4 BIRDSONG

Your Birdsong has three steps in the following order.

- 10.4.1 **Adjust Outcast.** Look at the cards in the Lost Souls pile, ignoring birds. The suit with the most cards becomes the new Outcast—move the outcast marker, showing its Outcast side, to that suit. If that suit was already the Outcast, flip the marker to Hated. If no one suit had the most cards, the marker stays on its current suit and, if it is not Hated, flips to its Hated side.
- 10.4.2 **Discard Lost Souls.** Discard all of the cards in the Lost Souls pile to the discard pile. (*Dominance cards become available to take.*)
- 10.4.3 **Perform Conspiracies.** You can spend acolytes, returning them to your supply, to perform conspiracies in clearings matching the Outcast, in any order and number, as follows. If the Outcast is Hated, the conspiracy costs one fewer acolyte.
- I **Crusade.** Spend two acolytes to initiate a battle in an Outcast clearing OR to move (*at least one warrior*) from an Outcast clearing and then, if you wish, initiate a battle in the destination clearing.
 - II **Convert.** Spend two acolytes to replace an enemy warrior from an Outcast clearing with a Cult warrior. (*To replace a piece, you must be able to remove the old piece and place the new piece.*)
 - III **Sanctify.** Spend three acolytes to replace an enemy building from an Outcast clearing with a garden of the Outcast suit.

10.5 DAYLIGHT

You may reveal any number of cards and perform one ritual per card revealed, in any order and number, as follows. (*Reveal cards from your hand into your play area. They cannot be used for any other purposes during Daylight.*)

- 10.5.1 **Build.** In a clearing you rule matching the revealed card, place a matching garden.
- 10.5.2 **Recruit.** In a clearing matching the revealed card, place a warrior.
- 10.5.3 **Score.** Spend the same card you reveal (*placing in Lost Souls*) to score the victory points listed above the rightmost empty Gardens space of the suit matching the revealed card. You may perform this only once per turn per suit.
- 10.5.4 **Sacrifice.** Place a warrior in the Acolytes box. To perform this ritual, you must reveal a bird card.

10.6 EVENING

Your Evening has three steps in the following order.

- 10.6.1 **Return Revealed Cards.** Return all cards you revealed this turn to your hand.
- 10.6.2 **Craft.** You may craft by activating gardens whose printed suit matches the Outcast suit.

- 10.6.3 **Draw and Discard.** Draw one card, plus one card per uncovered draw bonus. Then, if you have more than five cards in your hand, discard cards of your choice until you have five.

11. Riverfolk Company

11.1 OVERVIEW

When news arrived that the Woodland on the shore of the great lake was descending into all-out war, the Riverfolk Company quickly dispatched its officers to set up shop. As other factions purchase their services, the Riverfolk can further entrench their commercial interests by establishing TRADE POSTS along the river, scoring victory points. So too can they score points by raw accumulation of FUNDS, but a big treasury makes for an easy target, so the Riverfolk must take care in expanding their operations across the dangerous forest.

11.2 FACTION RULES AND ABILITIES

- 11.2.1 **Crafting.** The Riverfolk craft during Daylight by committing funds to empty spaces on the Trade Posts tracks. (*They have no crafting pieces.*)
- 11.2.2 **Swimmers.** The Riverfolk treat rivers as paths and may move along rivers regardless of who rules their origin or destination clearing. (*They can still move using paths.*)
- 11.2.3 **Public Hand.** The Riverfolk place their hand face up above their faction board. If another player would take a random card from the Riverfolk's hand, the cards are flipped face down, shuffled, drawn from, and then flipped face up.
- 11.2.4 **Funds.** To take many actions, the Riverfolk commit and spend FUNDS: warriors in their Funds box.
- 11.2.5 **Trade Posts.** The Riverfolk score victory points when they place trade posts.
- I **Trade Disruption.** Whenever a trade post is removed, the Riverfolk remove half of their funds, rounded up, and remove the trade post from the game permanently.
- 11.2.6 **Buying Services.** At the start of another player's Birdsong, that player may buy Riverfolk services.
- I **Cost.** The buyer must place warriors from their supply into the Riverfolk's Payments box equal in number to the cost of that service listed on the Riverfolk's Services track.
 - II **Number of Services.** Each turn, a player may buy one service plus one per clearing with a trade post and their faction pieces.
 - III **Vagabond Funds.** The Vagabond pays for services by exhausting items—for each item he exhausts to do so, the Riverfolk place one Riverfolk warrior in the Payments box.
- 11.2.7 **Riverfolk Services.** The Riverfolk offer three services, as follows.
- I **Hand Card.** The buyer takes any card from the Riverfolk's hand and adds it to their hand. (*The*

buyer may buy this service multiple times as long as they have access to enough trade posts.)

- II **Riverboats.** The buyer treats rivers as paths until the end of their turn.
- III **Mercenaries.** During Daylight and Evening of this turn, except when battling the Riverfolk, the buyer treats Riverfolk warriors as their own for rule and for battle. *(The buyer cannot move them, count them toward dominance, or remove them except by taking hits. They are still Riverfolk faction pieces, so they cannot be affected by abilities such as the Marquise's Field Hospitals or used in actions such as the Duchy's Sway Ministers.)*
 - a **Taking Hits.** The buyer must split hits, taking odd hits by removing owned (not Riverfolk) warriors, if any, or owned buildings or tokens only if they have no warriors (including Riverfolk) in the clearing of battle.
 - b **Vagabond Mercenaries.** The Vagabond cannot buy Riverfolk mercenaries. *(If a buyer battles the Vagabond and a Riverfolk mercenary warrior is removed, the buyer's faction becomes Hostile, not the Riverfolk.)*

11.3 FACTION SETUP

- 11.3.1 **Step 1: Gather Warriors.** Form a supply of 15 warriors.
- 11.3.2 **Step 2: Place Warriors.** Place 4 warriors in any clearings touching the river.
- 11.3.3 **Step 3: Fill Trade Posts Tracks.** Place 9 trade posts on the matching spaces of your Trade Posts tracks.
- 11.3.4 **Step 4: Gain Starting Funds.** Place 3 warriors in your Payments box.
- 11.3.5 **Step 5: Set Starting Prices.** Place 1 service marker on any space of each of your Services tracks.

11.4 BIRDSONG

Your Birdsong has three steps in the following order.

- 11.4.1 **Protectionism.** If the Payments box is empty, place two warriors in it.
- 11.4.2 **Score Dividends.** If there are any trade posts on the map, score one victory point per two funds. *(Do not score for warriors in Payments or Committed.)*
- 11.4.3 **Gather Funds.** Move all warriors on your faction board to the Funds box.

11.5 DAYLIGHT

You can commit and spend funds to take actions, as follows, in any order and number. When you commit a fund, move the warrior to the Committed box. When you spend a fund, return the warrior to its owner's supply.

- 11.5.1 **Move.** Commit one fund to take a move.
- 11.5.2 **Battle.** Commit one fund to initiate a battle.
- 11.5.3 **Craft.** Commit funds to craft a card from your

hand. Instead of moving these warriors to the Committed box, you must place them on empty spaces of the Trade Posts tracks matching the suits listed on the crafting cost.

- I **Export.** You may ignore the listed benefit of crafting a card, discarding it, to place one Riverfolk warrior in the Payments box.
- 11.5.4 **Draw.** Commit one fund to draw a card.
- 11.5.5 **Recruit.** Spend one fund to place a warrior in any clearing with a river.
- 11.5.6 **Establish Trade Post with Garrison.** Spend two funds to place a trade post and a warrior.
 - I **Choose Clearing.** Choose any clearing without a trade post that is ruled by any player.
 - II **Spend Funds.** Spend two funds of the player who rules the chosen clearing.
 - III **Place and Score.** Place the matching trade post and one warrior in the chosen clearing. Score the victory points listed on the space uncovered on your faction board.

11.6 EVENING

Your Evening has two steps in the following order.

- 11.6.1 **Discard Cards.** If you have more than five cards in your hand, discard cards of your choice until there are five.
- 11.6.2 **Set Costs.** You may move each service marker to any space on its track, setting it to a new cost.

The next two sections refer to factions in The Underworld Expansion.

12. Underground Duchy 🍷

12.1 OVERVIEW

The Underground Duchy wants to show the foreign creatures of the Woodland that they would be better off as subjects. As they set up frontier outposts to show their power in the Woodland, the Duchy can sway MINISTERS to the cause, scoring victory points and diverting more of the Duchy's resources. But be careful—a reversal of fortune could spell public humiliation, leading ministers to abandon the task.

12.2 FACTION RULES AND ABILITIES

- 12.2.1 **Crafting.** The Duchy crafts during Evening by activating citadels and markets.
- 12.2.2 **The Burrow.** THE BURROW is an unsuited clearing adjacent to each clearing with a tunnel token. Non-Duchy pieces cannot be placed in or moved into the Burrow. The Duchy always rules the Burrow *(even with no pieces there)*.
- 12.2.3 **The Price of Failure.** Whenever any number of Duchy buildings are removed, the Duchy returns their swayed minister card of highest rank *(lord, then noble, then squire)* to their Unswayed Ministers pile, and removes its crown from the game

permanently, then discards a random card. If they have multiple swayed ministers of highest rank, the Duchy chooses which to return.

- 12.2.4 **Tunnels.** The Duchy has three tunnel tokens. If the Duchy is prompted to place a tunnel but all three tunnels are on the map, the Duchy may first remove any tunnel from the map.

12.3 FACTION SETUP

- 12.3.1 **Step 1: Gather Warriors and Tunnels.** Form supplies of 20 warriors and 3 tunnel tokens.
- 12.3.2 **Step 2: Prepare the Burrow.** Place the Burrow board near the map.
- 12.3.3 **Step 3: Surface.** Place 2 warriors and 1 tunnel in a corner clearing that is not the starting corner clearing of another player and, if possible, is diagonally opposite from a starting corner clearing. This is your starting clearing. Then place 2 warriors in each clearing adjacent to the chosen corner clearing, except the Burrow. *(This is updated from earlier printings for flexibility.)*
- 12.3.4 **Step 4: Fill Buildings Tracks.** Place 3 citadels and 3 markets on your matching Buildings spaces.
- 12.3.5 **Step 5: Collect Ministers.** Place 9 minister cards face up on your Unswayed Ministers pile.
- 12.3.6 **Step 6: Fill Crown Spaces.** Place 9 crowns on the spaces with victory points on your faction board.

12.4 BIRDSONG

Place one warrior, plus one warrior per warrior icon showing, in the Burrow.

12.5 DAYLIGHT

Your Daylight has three steps in the following order.

- 12.5.1 **Assembly.** You may take up to two actions in any order and number, as follows.
- I **Build.** Reveal one card to place a citadel or market in a matching clearing you rule.
 - II **Recruit.** Place one warrior in the Burrow.
 - III **Move.** Take a move.
 - IV **Battle.** Initiate a battle.
 - V **Dig.** Spend one card to place a tunnel token in a matching clearing without a tunnel token. Then, move up to four warriors from the Burrow to that clearing. *(If all three tunnels are on the map, you may remove a tunnel first.)*
- 12.5.2 **Parliament.** You may take the action of each swayed minister once in any order.
- I **Foremole.** Reveal any card to place a citadel or market in any clearing *(matching or not)* you rule.
 - II **Captain.** Initiate a battle.
 - III **Marshal.** Take a move.
 - IV **Brigadier.** Take up to two moves or initiate up to two battles.
 - V **Banker.** Spend any number of cards *(even one)* of the same suit to score victory points in equal number.

- VI **Mayor.** Take the action of any swayed noble or squire.
- VII **Duchess of Mud.** Score two victory points if all three tunnels are on the map.
- VIII **Baron of Dirt.** Score one victory point per market on the map.
- IX **Earl of Stone.** Score one victory point per citadel on the map.

- 12.5.3 **Sway.** You may sway one minister, as follows.

- I **Choose Minister.** Choose a minister card in your Unswayed Ministers pile. You must have a crown on your faction board matching the rank *(squire, noble, lord)* of that minister.
- II **Reveal Cards.** Reveal the number of cards listed on the chosen minister. For each card you wish to reveal, you must have at least one Duchy piece in a clearing matching the suit of that card. Each such clearing allows you to reveal one matching card.
- III **Sway Minister and Score.** Take the chosen minister card and place it above your faction board. Take a crown of that minister's rank from your faction board and place it on the minister card. Score the victory points listed on the space uncovered on your faction board.

12.6 EVENING

Your Evening has three steps in the following order.

- 12.6.1 **Discard and Return Revealed Cards.** Discard any bird cards you revealed this turn, then return all other cards you revealed this turn to your hand.
- 12.6.2 **Craft.** You may craft by activating citadels and markets. *(These are identical for crafting purposes.)*
- 12.6.3 **Draw and Discard.** Draw one card, plus one card per card draw icon showing. Then, if you have more than five cards in your hand, discard cards of your choice until you have five.



13. Corvid Conspiracy

13.1 OVERVIEW

The Corvid Conspiracy seeks to strong-arm the Woodland into submission by completing criminal PLOTS, scoring victory points each time they flip one. The more revealed plots on the map, the more they score. Misdirection is critical—if their plans are too obvious, the Corvids risk exposure. To avoid this, they must recruit carefully and look for any opportunities for subterfuge and extortion.

13.2 FACTION RULES AND ABILITIES

- 13.2.1 **Crafting.** The Corvids craft during Birdsong by activating plot tokens (*whether face up or down*).
- 13.2.2 **Plot Tokens.** The Corvids have eight plot tokens, two of each type.
 - I **Token Facing.** While in the Corvids' supply, plot tokens are face down (*feather*). While on the map, a plot token can be face up (*unique icon*) or face down. The Corvids can inspect any facedown plot token at any time.
 - II **Placement Limits.** Each clearing can hold only one plot token.
- 13.2.3 **Nimble.** The Corvids can move regardless of who rules their origin or destination clearing.
- 13.2.4 **Exposure.** Anytime on their turn, but before drawing any cards in their Evening, an enemy player with faction pieces in a clearing with a facedown plot token may show the Corvids a matching card to guess the type of plot token in that clearing. If incorrect, the Corvids say “no,” and the enemy player gives that card to the Corvids. If correct, the enemy player removes the plot token (*scoring a victory point*) and ignores its effect.
- 13.2.5 **Embedded Agents.** As defender in battle, if the Corvids have a facedown plot token (*even defenseless*) in the clearing of battle, they deal an extra hit.

13.3 FACTION SETUP

- 13.3.1 **Step 1: Gather Warriors and Plots.** Form supplies of 15 warriors and 8 plot tokens face down.
- 13.3.2 **Step 2: Scatter.** Place 1 warrior in any clearing of each suit (*total of 3*).

13.4 BIRDSONG

Your Birdsong has three steps in the following order.

- 13.4.1 **Craft.** You may activate plot tokens (*whether face up or down*) to craft cards from your hand.
- 13.4.2 **Flip Plots.** Any number of times, flip a plot token face up in a clearing with any Corvid warriors, score one victory point per face-up plot token on the map (*including the newly flipped one*), and then resolve its flip effect if it is a bomb or extortion.
- 13.4.3 **Recruit.** Once per turn, you may spend any card to place one warrior in each matching clearing. (*If you spend a bird, choose one suit to place warriors in.*)

13.5 DAYLIGHT

You may take up to three actions, as follows, in any order and number.

- 13.5.1 **Move.** Take a move.
- 13.5.2 **Plot.** Remove a Corvid warrior, plus another Corvid warrior per plot you have placed this turn, from a clearing with no plot tokens to place a face-down plot token there.
- 13.5.3 **Battle.** Initiate a battle.
- 13.5.4 **Trick.** Swap two plot tokens on the map. Both plot tokens must be face up or face down.

13.6 EVENING

Your Evening has two steps in the following order.

- 13.6.1 **Exert.** You may take one action listed in Daylight if you choose to not draw cards during Evening.
- 13.6.2 **Draw.** Draw one card plus one card per face-up extortion token on the map. Then, if you have more than five cards, discard down to five cards.

13.7 PLOT TOKENS REFERENCE

- 13.7.1 **Bomb.** Whenever a bomb token is flipped, remove all enemy pieces in its clearing, then remove the bomb token.
- 13.7.2 **Snare.** While a snare token is face up, enemy pieces cannot be placed in or moved from its clearing.
- 13.7.3 **Extortion.** Whenever an extortion token is flipped, take a random card from each enemy player with faction pieces in its clearing. While an extortion token is face up, you draw another card in Evening.
- 13.7.4 **Raid.** Whenever a raid token is removed (*face up or down*), place one warrior in each clearing adjacent to the clearing from which the raid was removed. (*Ignore this effect if the raid is removed by Exposure.*)

*The next two sections refer to factions in
The Marauder Expansion*

14. Lord of the Hundreds

14.1 OVERVIEW

The Lord of the Hundreds suffers no fools and allows no dissent. During their Evening, they score points based on how well they OPPRESS their foes. The more clearings they rule that have a Hundreds piece and no enemy pieces—no warriors, no buildings, nothing—the more points they score. To grow in power and attract warriors, the Hundreds must gain items and add them to their towering HOARD. Leading the Hundreds is the WARLORD, a warrior-demagogue whose fickle MOOD gives them an ability for the turn. Their warlord is obsessed with hoarding, so as the Hundreds gain more items, they will have fewer moods to choose from. Declaring themselves as the true voice of the Woodland, the Hundreds can incite MOBS, which destroy enemy buildings and tokens, and raid ruins for items.

14.2 FACTION RULES AND ABILITIES

- 14.2.1 **Crafting.** The Hundreds craft during Daylight by activating strongholds.
- 14.2.2 **The Warlord.** The Hundreds have a piece called the warlord. The warlord is a warrior that cannot be removed outside of battle, moved outside of the Hundreds' turn, or placed in ways other than setup (14.3.2) and the Anoint action (14.4.3).
- 14.2.3 **Contempt for Trade.** Whenever the Hundreds craft an item, they may take the item but score none of the listed victory points, or may remove the item permanently to score the listed victory points. *(They can still score extra crafting points from effects such as Master Engravers and the Legendary Forge.)*
- 14.2.4 **The Hoard.** Instead of a Crafted Items box, the Hundreds have the Hoard box. This has two tracks, Command and Prowess. The Command track can hold , , and . The Prowess track can hold , , , and .
- I **Gaining Items.** When the Hundreds gain an item, they put it in the leftmost empty Command or Prowess space based on the item type; if there is no such empty space, they must permanently remove the gained item or any item on that track, and they score one victory point.
- II **Command and Prowess.** The number of items on the Command and Prowess tracks determine their Command and Prowess, which affect various parts of their rules. With no items, they have 1 Command or Prowess; with one or two items, they have 2; with three items, they have 3; with four items, they have 4.
- 14.2.5 **Looters.** At the start of battle as the attacker, the Hundreds may declare that they want to loot the defender, so long as the defender has an item in their Crafted Items box. *(They cannot loot the Vagabond.)* If they declare that they want to loot, the Hundreds deal no rolled hits. *(The defender deals rolled hits, and the Hundreds can still deal extra hits, such as from their Wrathful mood.)* Then, at the end of that battle, if the Hundreds rule the clearing of battle, they take one item from the defender's Crafted Items box.

14.3 FACTION SETUP

- 14.3.1 **Step 1: Gather Pieces.** Form supplies of 20 warriors, 1 warlord, and 6 strongholds.
- 14.3.2 **Step 2: Garrison.** Place your warlord, four warriors, and one stronghold in a corner clearing that is not the starting corner clearing of another player and, if possible, is diagonally opposite from a starting corner clearing.
- 14.3.3 **Step 3: Place Items.** Place the four "R" items randomly under the ruins, unless this has already been done.
- 14.3.4 **Step 4: Get Stubborn.** Place your Stubborn mood card on your Mood Card slot.

14.4 BIRDSONG

Your Birdsong has four steps in the following order.

- 14.4.1 **Raze.** In each clearing with a mob token, remove all enemy buildings and tokens, take one item from the ruin in the clearing, if any, and remove the ruin if you took its last item. After resolving all mobs, you must roll the mob die once and place a mob token in a matching clearing that has no mob token but is adjacent to a clearing with a mob token. *(If there are no such clearings, do not place a mob.)*
- 14.4.2 **Recruit.** Place warriors equal in number to your Prowess into the clearing with your warlord. Then, place warriors in each clearing with any strongholds, one warrior per stronghold there.
- 14.4.3 **Anoint.** If the warlord is not on the map, you must replace any Hundreds warrior on the map with the warlord. If you cannot, you must place the warlord in any clearing.
- 14.4.4 **Choose Mood.** You must replace the mood card in your Mood Card slot with a different mood card that does not show an item that is in your Hoard. If you are Lavish and cannot choose a new mood card, you remain Lavish.

14.5 DAYLIGHT

Your Daylight has three steps in the following order.

- 14.5.1 **Craft.** You may activate strongholds to craft cards.
- 14.5.2 **Command the Hundreds.** You may take the following actions, in any order, a number of times up to your Command.
- I **Move.** Take a move.
- II **Battle.** Initiate a battle.
- III **Build.** Spend a card to place a stronghold in a matching clearing that you rule.
- 14.5.3 **Advance the Warlord.** You may take this action a number of times up to your Prowess. You may move the warlord with any Hundreds warriors, and then you may battle in the warlord's clearing.

14.6 EVENING

Your Evening has three steps in the following order.

- 14.6.1 **Incite.** Any number of times, you may spend a card to place a mob token in a matching clearing that has no mob token but does have a Hundreds warrior *(including your warlord)*.
- 14.6.2 **Oppress.** You score victory points based on the number of clearings you rule that have a Hundreds piece and no enemy pieces. For one or two clearings, score one point; for three or four clearings, score two points; for five clearings, score three points; for six or more clearings, score four points.
- 14.6.3 **Draw and Discard.** Draw one card. Then, if you have more than five cards in your hand, discard cards of your choice until you have five.

14.7 MOODS

- 14.7.1 **Bitter** (☠). In battle in your warlord's clearing, before the roll you may remove any number of mob tokens from your warlord's clearing and any clearings adjacent to it. Place warriors in your warlord's clearing equal to the number of mob tokens you removed.
- 14.7.2 **Grandiose** (👑). This turn, perform your Advance the Warlord step (14.5.3) and your Command the Hundreds step (14.5.2) in reverse order. (*Advance the Warlord first, then Command the Hundreds.*)
- 14.7.3 **Jubilant** (🎉). Whenever you take the Incite action in your warlord's clearing, after placing the mob token for the action, you may—up to four times—roll the mob die and place a mob token in a matching clearing that has no mob token but is adjacent to any clearing with a mob token.
- 14.7.4 **Lavish (No Item)**. At the end of your Birdsong, you may remove any number of items from your Hoard permanently. For each item you remove, place two warriors into your warlord's clearing. When you are done, shift items in your Hoard to fill its tracks from left to right.
- 14.7.5 **Relentless** (👊). Whenever you take the Advance the Warlord action and both move and battle, you may then either move your warlord with any Hundreds warriors or battle in your warlord's clearing.
- 14.7.6 **Rowdy** (🍺). In Evening (14.6.3), draw one more card. If your warlord's clearing has three or more enemy pieces (even a combination of pieces from different enemies), draw two more cards instead.
- 14.7.7 **Stubborn** (🛡). In battle in your warlord's clearing, you ignore the first hit you take. (*This does not combine with other abilities that let you ignore the first hit you take.*)
- 14.7.8 **Wrathful** (🔪). As attacker in battle in your warlord's clearing, you deal an extra hit.

15. Keepers in Iron

15.1 OVERVIEW

The Keepers in Iron are an order of devout knights, once exiled from the Woodland, who have returned to recover RELICS lost in past conflicts. Whether these relics belong to the Keepers or the Woodland, though, is another question. To accomplish their mission, they will need to delve relics out of the forests, move them to a WAYSTATION of the same type, and then recover them. When they recover a relic, they score points equal to the relic's value of one to three, and they also score two points each time they complete a set of the three relic types—figures, tablets, and jewelry. Over time, the Keepers will gather a RETINUE of Woodland creatures, letting them take more actions. However, each time they delve a relic or recover one, they might lose the Retinue card they used to act, so they will need to plan ahead and take prudent risks in order to succeed.

15.2 FACTION RULES AND ABILITIES

- 15.2.1 **Relics**. You seek out twelve relic tokens of three types—figures, tablets, and jewelry. Each relic type has four tokens in total. The relic front shows only its type, and the relic back shows a value of 1, 2, 3, or 3.
- 15.2.2 **Waystations**. You have three waystations. Each waystation shows one relic type on its front and another relic type on its back.
- 15.2.3 **Crafting**. The Keepers craft during Daylight by activating waystations (*of any type*).
- 15.2.4 **Devout Knights**. In battle, if the clearing of battle has at least one relic and at least one Keeper warrior, the Keepers ignore the first hit they take. (*If ambushed, ignore one hit from the ambush, but do not ignore further hits.*) When moving, the Keepers may move one relic with each Keeper warrior that they move.
- 15.2.5 **Prized Trophies**. Whenever an enemy removes a relic, they place it in any forest face up and score an extra victory point (*for a total of two*).

15.3 FACTION SETUP

- 15.3.1 **Step 1: Place Starting Relics**. Collect all twelve relic tokens and shuffle them face down (*without the value showing*). Place one randomly in each forest. (*We recommend that you just slide the relics around face down, then place relics as fast as possible as a group. Otherwise, you can use this more random but fiddly method: the Keepers stack the randomized relics, then any other player cuts the stack, picks it up, and drops relics one by one from the bottom onto the forests.*)
- 15.3.2 **Step 2: Gather Warriors**. Form a supply of 15 warriors.
- 15.3.3 **Step 3: Place Warriors**. Place four warriors in a corner clearing that is not the starting corner clearing of another player and, if possible, is diagonally opposite from a starting corner clearing. Then, place four warriors in a clearing on the map edge that is adjacent to the chosen clearing.
- 15.3.4 **Step 4: Place Remaining Relics**. Place all remaining relics randomly, as evenly as possible, among forests not adjacent to clearings with your warriors.
- 15.3.5 **Step 5: Tuck Faithful Retainers**. Tuck one Faithful Retainer card into each Retinue slot of your faction board.
- 15.3.6 **Step 6: Collect Waystations**. Place your three waystation buildings on the matching Waystations spaces of your faction board.

15.4 BIRDSONG

Your Birdsong has three steps in the following order.

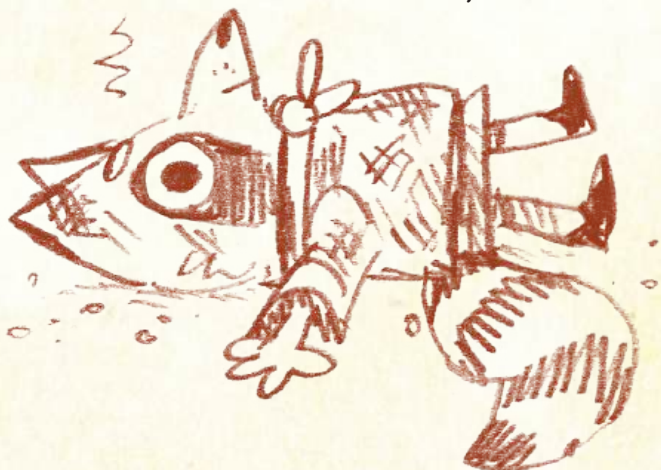
- 15.4.1 **Encamp**. Once per clearing, you may replace a Keeper warrior with a waystation. If you have no warriors or waystations on the map, instead place one waystation and one warrior in any clearing on the map edge. In either case, you may place the waystation face up or face down.

- 15.4.2 **Decamp.** Once per clearing, you may replace a waystation with a Keeper warrior.
- 15.4.3 **Recruit.** Any number of times, you may spend a card to place two warriors at a matching waystation.

15.5 DAYLIGHT

Your Daylight has two steps in the following order.

- 15.5.1 **Craft.** You may activate waystations (*of any type*) to craft cards.
- 15.5.2 **Act with Retinue.** Starting with the leftmost column of your Retinue and moving to the right, you may take the column's action, as follows, for each card in the column in any order.
- I **Move.** Take a move from a clearing whose suit matches the card suit.
 - II **Battle then Delve.** Choose a clearing whose suit matches the card suit. You must initiate a battle there if any enemy pieces are there. Then, if you rule the clearing and it has at least one Keeper warrior, you may delve there as follows (*even if there was no enemy to battle*).
 - a **Step 1: Move and Flip Relic.** Move any relic from an adjacent forest into that clearing. Flip that relic so its value is showing if it is not.
 - b **Step 2: Check for Discard.** Count the number of clearings you rule adjacent to the forest from which you delved the relic. If you rule fewer of these clearings than the relic's value, then you must discard the Retinue card used to take this action.
 - III **Move or Recover.** Choose a clearing whose suit matches the card suit. Take a move from it, or recover relics from it as follows.
 - a **Step 1: Take Relic.** Take a relic there of the same type as a waystation there. Place it in your leftmost empty Relics space of that relic type.
 - b **Step 2: Score Points.** Score victory points equal to the relic's value, and score two victory points if you filled a Relics column.
 - c **Step 3: Check for Discard.** Count the number of clearings you rule whose suit matches the clearing from which you are recovering the relic. If you rule fewer of these clearings than the relic's value, then you must end this



Recover action and discard the Retinue card used to take this action. Otherwise, you may return to the Take Relic step or end this Recover action.

15.6 EVENING

Your Evening has three steps in the following order.

- 15.6.1 **Live Off the Land.** You must remove one Keeper warrior from each clearing that has four or more Keeper warriors.
- 15.6.2 **Gather Retinue.** You may add any number of cards from your hand to any Retinue slots, or you may shift one card in your Retinue to a different slot. Your Retinue cannot hold more than ten cards.
- 15.6.3 **Draw and Discard.** Draw one card, plus one card per uncovered draw bonus (*equal to waystations on the map*). Then, if you have more than five cards in your hand, discard cards of your choice until you have five.

APPENDICES

A. Advanced Setup

There are hundreds of ways to play *Root*. The icons next to the setup steps note which *Root* products (Appendix B) include options for that step.

A.1 STEP 1: CHOOSE AND SET UP MAP

As a group, choose a map. If you choose a variant map (Appendix C), follow its Setup Modification section, then collect the 12 suit markers, flip them face down, and shuffle them, then place one on each clearing, covering the printed suit symbols if any. Set up the ruins (5.1.4), item supply (5.1.5), and dice (5.1.6) as normal.

A.2 STEP 2: CHOOSE DECK

As a group, you may choose to replace the entire standard deck with the Exiles and Partisans deck.

A.3 STEP 3: SET UP BOTS

As a group, you may choose to play with bots, as described in the Law of Rootbotics.

A.4 STEP 4: SEAT PLAYERS

Determine the seating order and the first player randomly.

A.5 STEP 5: SET UP LANDMARKS

As a group, you may choose to use landmarks (Appendix F). If so, you may ignore or override the placement of the Tower and Ferry pieces described in Variant Maps (Appendix C).

- A.5.1 **Step 1: Choose.** As a group, choose if you're playing with one or two landmarks, and remove any landmark cards you do not want to play with.
- A.5.2 **Step 2: Deal and Collect.** Shuffle the chosen landmark cards, deal out the chosen number, and collect the landmark piece shown on each dealt card.

A.5.3 **Step 3: Set Up.** The last player in turn order sets up one drawn landmark as described on its card. If you chose to play with two landmarks, the second-to-last player in turn order sets up the other drawn landmark as described on its card.

A.6 STEP 6: SET UP HIRELINGS

As a group, you may choose to use exactly three hirelings (Appendix E), as follows.

A.6.1 **Step 1: Collect Pieces.** Shuffle all the hirelings cards. Deal out three hiring cards and return the rest to the box. Collect the pieces for the dealt hiring cards into a supply.

A.6.2 **Step 2: Demote.** If playing with three players, flip over one random hiring to its Demoted side (*marked with a "D"*). If playing with four players, flip over two random hirelings to their Demoted side. If playing with five or more players, flip over all three hirelings to their Demoted side.

A.6.3 **Step 3: Set Up Hirelings.** Starting with the last player in turn order and going counterclockwise, players set up one dealt hiring each as described on its hiring card. (*Some have no setup instructions.*)

A.6.4 **Step 4: Place Hiring Markers.** Place the three hiring markers—marked “4,” “8,” and “12”—on the “4,” “8,” and “12” spaces of the score track on the map.

A.6.5 **Step 5: Return Corresponding Factions.** A faction cannot be played if its corresponding hiring is in play (*shown by color and icon*). Return the corresponding faction boards, pieces, and setup cards to the box.

A.7 STEP 7: DRAW FIVE CARDS

If you are playing with two players, remove all four dominance cards from the deck. Shuffle the deck. Each player draws five cards. (*Not three, as in Standard Setup! You will choose three cards to keep in step 10.*)

A.8 STEP 8: SET UP FACTIONS

As a group, you may choose and set up factions as described in the Standard Setup (5.1) or you may use the faction setup cards included in the Marauder Expansion, as described below.

A.8.1 **Step 1: Deal Setup Cards.** Shuffle all of the militant faction setup cards (*red name with sword*) and deal out one card to a pool in the center of the table. Shuffle the remaining militant faction setup cards together with all of the insurgent faction setup cards (*grey name with no sword*), and deal out one faction setup card per player. (*There will be one more faction setup card than the number of players.*)

- I **Two Players.** If you're playing with two players, remove all of the insurgent faction setup cards before dealing out any. (*You may keep them if you're playing with hirelings and feeling adventurous.*)
- II **Lock Last Insurgent.** If the last faction setup card dealt out is an insurgent, turn it sideways to show that it is locked. It cannot be chosen unless at least one militant faction has been chosen.

III **Vagabond.** Whenever a Vagabond faction setup card is dealt out, also deal out one random character card next to it face up. If a player chooses this Vagabond as their faction, they must use this character card.

A.8.2 **Step 2: Choose Factions.** Starting with the last player in turn order and going counterclockwise, each player chooses one faction setup card from the pool and sets up the faction immediately as it describes (*before another player chooses*).

- I **Homelands.** When setting up, players might choose one or more homeland clearings. Players cannot choose homelands that enemies have chosen as their homelands or where they cannot place all the pieces listed in setup.
- II **Enemy Homeland Adjacency.** Some factions require you to choose a homeland that is not adjacent to enemy homelands; if you cannot do this, choose a homeland adjacent to an enemy homeland. If you must choose a homeland that has two or more clearings between it and enemy homelands but you cannot, choose a homeland that is not adjacent to enemy homelands. (*Basically, try to set up as far away as able.*)
- III **Multiple Homeland Adjacency.** If your faction has multiple homelands and you cannot fulfill all of their enemy adjacency requirements (A.8.2.II), choose and set them up one at a time, fulfilling each requirement as best you can.

A.9 STEP 9: PLACE SCORE MARKERS

Each player places their faction's score marker on the “0” space on the score track.

A.10 STEP 10: CHOOSE STARTING HANDS

Each player chooses three cards in their hand to keep and puts the other two cards face down on the shared deck. When finished, shuffle the shared deck.

B. Components

B.1 ROOT

- B.1.1 **Booklets.** Walkthrough, Learning to Play, and this Law.
- B.1.2 **Cardboard Pieces.** 28 Buildings (*7 Roosts, 6 Sawmills, 6 Recruiters, 6 Workshops, 3 Bases*), 19 Tokens (*10 Sympathy, 8 Wood, 1 Keep*), 12 Clearing Markers (*4 Rabbit, 4 Fox, 4 Mouse*), 4 Ruins, 4 Victory Point Markers, 3 Relationship Markers, 23 Items (*4 Boots, 4 Swords, 4 Bags, 3 Hammers, 3 Tea, 2 Coins, 2 Crossbows, 1 Torch*).
- B.1.3 **Wooden Pieces.** 55 Warriors (*25 Marquise, 20 Eyrie, 10 Alliance*), 1 Vagabond Pawn.
- B.1.4 **Cards.** 54 Cards for Shared Deck, 16 Faction Overviews, 4 Eyrie Leaders, 2 Loyal Viziers, 3 Vagabond Characters, 15 Quests, 4 Walkthroughs.
- B.1.5 **Other.** Board (*Fall and Winter Maps*), 2 Dice, 4 Faction Boards (*Marquise, Eyrie, Alliance, Vagabond*).

B.2 RIVERFOLK EXPANSION

- B.2.1 **Booklets.** Learning to Play.
- B.2.2 **Cardboard Pieces.** 15 Buildings (*15 Gardens*), 9 Tokens (*9 Trade Posts*), 3 Victory Point Markers, 1 Outcast Marker, 9 Relationship Markers, 11 Items (*3 Boots, 3 Swords, 1 Bag, 1 Hammer, 1 Torch, 1 Coins, 1 Crossbow*), and 17 spare pieces with letter backs for future scenarios.
- B.2.3 **Wooden Pieces.** 40 Warriors (*25 Lizard, 15 Riverfolk*), 1 Vagabond Pawn.
- B.2.4 **Cards.** 4 Spies, 2 Faction Overviews, 3 Vagabond Characters.
- B.2.5 **Other.** 4 Faction Boards (*Second Vagabond, Mechanical Marquise, Riverfolk Company, Lizard Cult*), 3 Service Markers, 1 Card Stand.

B.3 UNDERWORLD EXPANSION

- B.3.1 **Booklets.** Learning to Play and this Law.
- B.3.2 **Cardboard Pieces.** 6 Buildings (*3 Markets, 3 Citadels*), 19 Tokens (*8 Plots, 8 Spare Plots, 3 Tunnels*), the Burrow, 4 Relationship Markers, 2 Victory Point Markers, 6 Closed Path Markers.
- B.3.3 **Wooden Pieces.** 35 Warriors (*20 Duchy, 15 Corvid*), 1 Ferry, 1 Tower, 9 Crowns.
- B.3.4 **Cards.** 9 Ministers, 2 Overviews.
- B.3.5 **Other.** Board (*Lake and Mountain Maps*), 2 Dice, 2 Faction Boards (*Duchy, Corvid*).

B.4 MARAUDER EXPANSION

- B.4.1 **Booklets.** Learning to Play and this Law.
- B.4.2 **Cardboard Pieces.** 9 Buildings (*3 Waystations, 6 Strongholds*), 17 Tokens (*12 Relics, 5 Mobs*), 4 Relationship Markers, 2 Victory Point Markers, 12 Control Markers, 3 Club Items, 3 Hireling Markers, 11 Extra Markers (*9 Victory Points, 2 Relationships*).
- B.4.3 **Wooden Pieces.** 56 Warriors (*20 Hundreds, 15 Keepers, 12 Patrol, 5 Dynasty, 4 Uprising*), 1 Hundreds Warlord, 1 Exile Pawn.
- B.4.4 **Cards.** 8 Moods, 3 Faithful Retainers, 10 Faction Setup, 4 Hirelings, 2 Overviews.
- B.4.5 **Other.** 2 Faction Boards (*Hundreds, Keepers*), 3 Dice (*Mob, Uprising, Control*).

B.5 CLOCKWORK EXPANSION

- B.5.1 **Booklets.** Law of Rootbotics.
- B.5.2 **Cardboard Pieces.** 12 Priority Markers.
- B.5.3 **Cards.** 12 Difficulties, 16 Traits, 3 Vagabots.
- B.5.4 **Other.** 4 Faction Boards.

B.6 CLOCKWORK EXPANSION 2

- B.6.1 **Booklets.** Law of Rootbotics.
- B.6.2 **Cardboard Pieces.** 12 Priority Markers.
- B.6.3 **Cards.** 12 Difficulties, 20 Traits, 3 Vagabots, 1 Interaction, 11 Services.
- B.6.4 **Other.** 4 Faction Boards.

B.7 EXILES AND PARTISANS DECK

- B.7.1 **Cards.** 54 Cards for Shared Deck.

B.8 LANDMARKS PACK

- B.8.1 **Cards.** 1 Setup/Rules, 6 Landmarks.
- B.8.2 **Wooden Pieces.** 4 Landmarks.

B.9 VAGABOND PACK

- B.9.1 **Cardboard Pieces.** 3 Items (*1 Coins, 1 Hammer, 1 Boot*)
- B.9.2 **Wooden Pieces.** 7 Vagabond Pawns.
- B.9.3 **Cards.** 3 Vagabond Characters.

B.10 HIRELING PACKS

- B.10.1 **Booklets.** Learning to Play Hirelings.
- B.10.2 **Cardboard Pieces.** 3 Hireling Markers, 12 Control Markers. 3 Foothold Tokens in Underworld Pack. 6 Vault Buildings in Marauder Pack.
- B.10.3 **Wooden Pieces.** 1 Flotilla Pawn, 4 Prophet Warriors, 4 Bandit Warriors in Riverfolk Pack. 8 Expedition Warriors, 6 Spy Warriors, and 1 Protector Pawn in Underworld Pack. 6 Bearer Warriors, 6 Keeper Warriors, and 5 Band Warriors in Marauder Pack.
- B.10.4 **Cards.** 3 Hirelings.
- B.10.5 **Other.** 1 Control Die.

C. Variant Maps

C.1 WINTER MAP

- C.1.1 **Raging River.** The river divides forests (*as printed paths do*).

C.2 LAKE MAP

- C.2.1 **Setup Modifications.** Place the Ferry piece in the corner clearing that is also a coastal clearing.
- C.2.2 **The Lake.** The LAKE is in the center of the map. The lake is treated as rivers linking each coastal clearing to each other coastal clearing. The lake divides forests.
- C.2.3 **Coastal Clearings.** Clearings touching the lake (*not separated by a forest*) are COASTAL CLEARINGS.
- C.2.4 **Coastal Forests.** Forests touching the lake are COASTAL FORESTS. Each coastal forest is adjacent to its two neighboring coastal forests (*separated by one coastal clearing*).
- C.2.5 **The Ferry.** Once per turn, pieces moving from the coastal clearing with the Ferry can move on the lake to any other coastal clearing, ignoring adjacency, and moving the Ferry along with them. (*You still must rule the origin or destination clearing.*) After this, the moving player draws one card. The Ferry cannot be battled or removed.

C.3 MOUNTAIN MAP

- C.3.1 **Setup Modifications.** Place the 6 closed path markers to cover the 6 paths of darker color with excavated ground. Place the Tower piece in the central clearing showing two towers.
- C.3.2 **Closed Paths.** A path covered with a closed path marker is a CLOSED PATH. Clearings linked by a closed path are not adjacent, and pieces (*such as Highway Bandits*) cannot be placed on closed paths. Closed paths enclose and divide forests as if they were paths (*so the Vagabond can slip across it*).
- C.3.3 **Removing Closed Paths.** Once per turn in their Daylight, a player can spend a card to remove a closed path marker from the game permanently and score one victory point. To remove it, that player must have any faction pieces in either clearing linked by the closed path marker.
- C.3.4 **The Pass and Tower.** The clearing marked with the Tower piece is THE PASS. At the end of a player's Evening, if that player rules the Pass, that player scores one victory point.
- C.3.5 **Forests.** All areas on the mountain map enclosed by paths and clearings are forests (2.2), regardless of the presence or placement of trees within.

D. Vagabonds

D.1 THIEF

- D.1.1 **Starting Items.** Start with [B], [P], [H], [S].
- D.1.2 **Special Action: Steal.** Exhaust one [P] to take a random card from any player in your clearing.

D.2 TINKER

- D.2.1 **Starting Items.** Start with [B], [P], [H], [S].
- D.2.2 **Special Action: Day Labor.** Exhaust one [P] to take a card from the discard pile whose suit matches your clearing. (*You can always take a bird card.*)

D.3 RANGER

- D.3.1 **Starting Items.** Start with [B], [P], [S], [S].
- D.3.2 **Special Action: Hideout.** Exhaust one [P] to repair three items. Then, immediately end Daylight and begin Evening.

D.4 VAGRANT

- D.4.1 **Starting Items.** Start with [S], [P], [B].
- D.4.2 **Special Action: Instigate.** Exhaust a [P] to initiate a battle in your clearing. You choose the attacker and defender, you choose the order in which they each remove their own buildings and tokens, and you remove pieces for each. (*Score a victory point per building or token of either player removed, and per Hostile piece of either player removed.*)

D.5 ARBITER

- D.5.1 **Starting Items.** Start with [B], [P], [S], [S].
- D.5.2 **Special Action: Protector.** Before dice are rolled in a battle, the defender may enlist the Arbiter in

the clearing of battle. The Arbiter scores one victory point and adds all of his undamaged [S] to the maximum rolled hits of the defender. The Arbiter cannot enlist himself or be enlisted against himself.

D.6 SCOUNDREL

- D.6.1 **Starting Items.** Start with [B], [B], [P], [S].
- D.6.2 **Special Action: Scorched Earth.** Exhaust a [P] and place it in your clearing. Remove all enemy pieces from that clearing. Pieces cannot be placed in or moved into the clearing with the [P]. (*You remain in this clearing. Once you move out, you cannot move back in. The [P] cannot be removed with a "Favor of the..." card because it is not an enemy piece.*)

D.7 ADVENTURER

- D.7.1 **Starting Items.** Start with [B], [P], [S].
- D.7.2 **Special Action: Improve.** Once per turn while taking the Quest action, you may treat one unexhausted item as any other item. When you exhaust it to complete the quest, also damage that item.

D.8 RONIN

- D.8.1 **Starting Items.** Start with [B], [B], [P], [S].
- D.8.2 **Special Action: Swift Strike.** You may exhaust a [S] to deal an extra hit in battle (*after rolling*).

D.9 HARRIER

- D.9.1 **Starting Items.** Start with [S], [P], [S], [S].
- D.9.2 **Special Action: Glide.** Exhaust a [P] to move only your Vagabond pawn (*not other pieces*) to any clearing (*even Hostile*) on the map, ignoring adjacency and paths, without exhausting any [B].

E. Hirelings

E.1 GAINING AND LOSING HIRELINGS

- E.1.1 **Gaining from Supply.** When a player's score marker enters a space with a hiring marker, they take the hiring marker and place it below their Evening (*as a reminder*). At the end of their turn, they take any hiring card from the supply, roll for control (1.2), and flip over the hiring marker.
- E.1.2 **Rolling for Control.** When a player gains a hiring card, they roll the control die and place con-



trol markers on the hireling card equal in number to the die roll. They count only the gold die pips if they have the most victory points or are tied for the most; they count all the die pips otherwise (*including if they have activated a dominance card*).

- E.1.3 **Gaining from Another Player.** At the end of a player's turn, they must remove one control marker from each hireling card they gained on previous turns. Then, they must give each hireling card they control that has no control markers, along with a hireling marker, to any other player (*even the player with the highest score*). That player puts the hireling marker below their Evening (*as a reminder*) and immediately rolls for control (1.2).

E.2 ABILITIES AND ACTIONS

Hirelings have various actions and abilities, as shown by unique icons. Actions and abilities that start with "CONTROLLER:" are gained by the hireling's controller.

- E.2.1 **When-Hired Action** () . When they take control of the hireling, the controlling player must take this action.
- E.2.2 **Ability** () . This ability is always active or it specifies when it happens.
- E.2.3 **Start-of-Birdsong Action** () . At the start of their Birdsong, the controlling player must or may take this action, as the action describes.
- E.2.4 **Once-Per-Daylight Action** () . Once in their Daylight, the controlling player may take this action.

E.3 RULES

- E.3.1 **Rule.** A hireling's controller treats hireling pieces as their own only for rule. (*The controller can rule a clearing even with hirelings alone.*) Uncontrolled hirelings can rule clearings as if they were players (2.5).
- E.3.2 **Enemy Status.** A hireling is an enemy to players other than its controller and players in coalition with its controller.
- E.3.3 **Separate Pieces.** Hireling pieces are not the controller's faction pieces. (*So, the Duchy cannot count them as Duchy pieces to sway, the Keepers cannot remove them to encamp, etc.*).
- E.3.4 **Separate Actions.** A hireling's Move or Battle actions can only move or battle with the hireling's pieces and cannot include the controller's pieces. Hirelings cannot take actions in other ways (*such as from their controller's Move actions, False Orders, or the Vagabond's Allied Relationship*).
- E.3.5 **Separate Effects.** Hirelings cannot use their controller's abilities, crafted persistent effects, or ambush cards. (*So, a hireling could not use Boat Builders while moving, and the Highway Bandits could not be placed on a river. A hireling's controller could not play an ambush card while battling with the hireling.*)
- E.3.6 **No Scoring from Removal.** A hireling's controller does not score victory points if their hireling removes an enemy piece (*usually in battle*). (*Play-*

ers can still score points by removing hireling buildings and tokens, even when defending in battle against the hireling. Players still score as normal if the Warm Sun Prophets force that player's faction pieces to battle.)

- E.3.7 **Weird Stuff.** If you move a hireling with the Ferry, you do draw a card. If you move hireling warriors into a clearing with an Alliance sympathy token or remove Alliance sympathy by using a hireling, this does trigger Outrage. (*These effects refer to a "player moving" or "player removing."*)

F. Landmarks

F.1 GENERAL RULES

- F.1.1 **Safety.** Landmarks cannot be battled, moved, or removed, unless noted explicitly by a landmark.
- F.1.2 **Ownership.** Landmarks are not owned by any faction and are not enemy pieces.

G. Glossary

- G.1.1 **Ability.** A persistent effect of a faction as listed at the top of its faction board and in its Faction Rules and Abilities section, or a persistent effect of a hireling as listed on its hireling card (E.2.1).
- G.1.2 **Adjacent.** A clearing is adjacent to all other clearings linked to it by a path. A forest is adjacent to all clearings that touch it without crossing a path, and it is adjacent to all forests that are separated by only one path, except on the lake (C.2.4). 
- G.1.3 **Building.** A square cardboard piece owned by its faction.
- G.1.4 **Cannot.** See 1.1.2.
- G.1.5 **Discard.** Place the prompted card in the shared discard pile (2.1). If it is a dominance card, place it near the map instead (3.3.3). 
- G.1.6 **Draw.** Take the top card from the shared deck (2.1).
- G.1.7 **Effect.** Anything that changes the game, including persistent effects, faction abilities, and actions.
- G.1.8 **Enemy.** Any other player that you are not in a coalition with (9.2.8), or a hireling that is in the supply or held by an enemy player.
- G.1.9 **Enemy Piece.** A faction piece of an enemy player or a hireling piece of an enemy hireling, except while you're treating the piece as your own for rule (*Riverfolk mercenaries, controlled hirelings, etc.*). (*Items cannot be enemy pieces.*)
- G.1.10 **Faction Piece.** All the warriors, pawns, buildings, and tokens listed on the back of a faction board. (*Items are not faction pieces.*) See 1.5.2.
- G.1.11 **Forest.** An area on the map enclosed by paths and clearings.
- G.1.12 **Force.** See 1.5.5.
- G.1.13 **Item.** A square cardboard piece showing an item (, , , etc.) that is not owned by any faction.
- G.1.14 **Map.** See 2.2.

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- G.1.15 **Map Edge.** The single closed loop of clearings and paths that define the map boundary, including closed paths on the mountain map.
- G.1.16 **Path.** A white link between two clearings.
- G.1.17 **Pawn.** A wooden figure owned by its faction.
- G.1.18 **Piece.** Any component—building, token, warrior, pawn, item, marker, and so on.
- G.1.19 **Place.** Take the prompted piece from the prompted source and put it in the prompted destination. Usually, no source is specified—in this case, take it from its supply, or take the leftmost prompted piece if it is on a track. *Put* is shorthand for *Place*.
- G.1.20 **Play Area.** The area around your faction board. Cards in it can only be spent, discarded, or used for other purposes if explicitly instructed.
- G.1.21 **Replace.** Shorthand for REMOVE then PLACE. Remove the prompted piece and place the other prompted piece in location from which the first was removed. You must complete all steps of the REPLACE in order to do it.
- G.1.22 **Remove.** Take the prompted piece from the prompted source and return it to the prompted destination. Usually, no destination is specified—in this case, return it to its owner's supply, return it to the rightmost empty space of its track it has one, or remove it permanently otherwise. (*Items are removed permanently.*)
- G.1.23 **Reveal.** Place the prompted card face up in your play area. Usually, no source is specified—in this case, take it from your hand.
- G.1.24 **River.** A blue link between two clearings.
- G.1.25 **Ruin.** Piece covering an “R” slot in a clearing (2.2.4).
- G.1.26 **Rule.** See 2.5.
- G.1.27 **Show.** Let the prompted player see the prompted piece.
- G.1.28 **Slot.** White box in a clearing (2.2.3).
- G.1.29 **Spend.** See DISCARD. (*These terms are equivalent, but SPEND is used in contexts with choice.*)
- G.1.30 **Supply.** The collection of pieces that is not on a faction board or the map. The item supply is the collection of items on the map.
- G.1.31 **Swap.** Switch the locations of the two prompted pieces. (*This ignores MOVE and PLACE restrictions, such as the Corvids' snare and the Marquise's keep.*)
- G.1.32 **Token.** A circular cardboard piece owned by its faction.
- G.1.33 **Treat.** The prompted thing takes on the properties of the second prompted thing. While you treat enemy pieces as your own for rule, they are not enemy pieces, but they are still faction pieces of that enemy player. (*For example, Riverfolk warriors you've hired as mercenaries are not enemy pieces to you, but they are still Riverfolk faction pieces.*)
- G.1.34 **Warrior.** A wooden figure owned by its faction. (*The Vagabond pawn is not a warrior and cannot be removed.*)

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Cole dedicates this game to his younger brothers and sisters, who never let him forget how to play.

Kyle dedicates this game to his children, who have always requested cute animal drawings.

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Key References

CRAFT (4.1)

Play a card and activate the crafting pieces of the suits listed in its bottom-left corner. (*Vagabond exhausts* ) The suit of a crafting piece matches its clearing, and you can activate each crafting piece only once per turn.

If you craft an IMMEDIATE EFFECT, resolve it and discard the card. Often these effects will let you take an item from the supply on the map and score victory points. If the item supply on the map does not have the listed item to take, you cannot craft the card.

If you craft a PERSISTENT EFFECT, place the card in your play area. You may use its effect. You cannot craft a persistent effect if you have one of the same name.

MOVE (4.2)

Take any of your warriors and pawns from one clearing and move them to one adjacent clearing.

You must rule the origin, destination, or both. A given piece can be moved any number of times per turn.

BATTLE (4.3)

You can battle in a clearing with your warriors or pawn.

Step 1: Defender May Ambush. Attacker may cancel defender’s ambush card by also playing ambush card.

Step 2: Roll Dice. Attacker will deal hits equal to **higher** roll. Defender will deal hits equal to **lower** roll.

The maximum hits you can deal by rolling equals your number of warriors in the clearing of battle.

Step 3: Use Effects. The players may use optional effects that affect battle now. Many deal EXTRA HITS, which are not limited by warriors.

Defenseless: If the defender has no warriors in the clearing of battle, the attacker deals an extra hit.

Step 4: Deal Hits. Each hit removes one piece—warriors first, then buildings and tokens, as chosen by the player taking the hits.

Remember: *Score a victory point each time you remove an enemy building or token.*

SETUP (5.1)

Step 1: Assign factions, then determine starting player and seating order randomly. Give board and pieces.

Step 2: Place score markers on the “0” space.

Step 3: Draw and give three cards to each player.

Step 4: Place ruins in the four slots marked with “R.”

Step 5: Form item supply near the top of the map.

Step 6: Gather dice and overview cards if desired.

Step 7: Set up factions in setup order (A, B, C, etc.).